

Chapter 6

Hydrodynamics

Reality continues to ruin my life.

Bill Watterson

Gas and fluid dynamics play an important role in many astrophysical processes. When addressing these physical phenomena, we refer to the collection of solvers by the generic term *hydrodynamics*. Gas dynamics forms the basis for our understanding of star and planet formation; it drives X-ray sources and accretion onto supermassive black holes; it dictates the appearance of galaxies. In AMUSE, hydrodynamics is addressed numerically using two quite distinct methods: the Lagrangian formalism with smoothed particles, and Eulerian grid-based finite volume formalisms. These approaches are complementary. Hybrid approaches that combine the advantages of both methods are also available in AMUSE. Simulating hydrodynamics is an art, but one with a solid mathematical background.

6.1 In a Nutshell

Hydrodynamics deals with the motion of fluids driven by internal and external forces, for example due to pressure gradients and gravity. Although fluid dynamics is important for everyday life, we discuss it here in the context of astronomical phenomena. That means we will largely ignore many important fluid properties, such as viscosity and surface tension, that are critical to Earth-bound applications.

In AMUSE, we confine ourselves to a continuum description of the gas—we do not attempt to describe the microscopic behavior of its constituent particles. In doing so, we are assuming that we can sensibly define thermodynamic quantities, such as density and temperature, on the spatial scales of interest. In numerical simulations, the spatial variation of fluid properties may be represented in a variety of different ways—on a regular grid, or an irregular tessellation, or in terms of a collection of macroscopic particles that sample the fluid at different locations. In all cases, if the sampling scale is λ , the gas has number density n , and we are interested in a physical flow with characteristic length scale L , then we require $\lambda \ll L$ and $n\lambda^3 \gg 1$ (that is, a resolution element should contain many particles but still be much smaller than the length scales

of interest). Fortunately, these requirements are often met and we can make reliable quantitative statements about the fluid flow.

Some astrophysical processes—for example, jets, stellar winds, and supernova explosions—have symmetries that may allow a good approximation by reducing the dimensionality of the problem, but often no such simplification exists. In addition, there is a wide range of instabilities for which the typical length scale depends on the dimensionality of the problem, as in the Rayleigh–Taylor (dense fluid on top of a low-density fluid) and Kelvin–Helmholtz (shear between two fluids) instabilities. For these reasons, we address here only the hardest problem—fluid dynamics in three dimensions.

Solving the fundamental equations of hydrodynamics is one of the hardest numerical problems in computational science. Three-dimensional fluid flows are very computationally demanding. The underlying equations are nonlinear and the dynamic range may exceed algorithmic capabilities by orders of magnitude. At the same time, there is only a very limited set of analytic solutions against which numerical implementations can be tested (Coggeshall, 1991). Laboratory experiments are possible, but it is often hard to compare them quantitatively with simulations, especially in astrophysics. There are a number of excellent resources on hydrodynamics, ranging from basic but comprehensive introductions (Landau & Lifshitz, 1959) to more astronomically oriented texts (Shore, 2007; Regev *et al.*, 2016).

6.1.1 Underlying Equations

Astrophysical fluids can be described by a relatively small number of variables. A fluid element has position $\mathbf{x}$ and velocity $\mathbf{v}$, as well as internal thermodynamic properties, such as density ρ , composition, pressure P , temperature T , entropy s , and so on. For astrophysical systems, the composition is usually no more complicated than specifying just the hydrogen mass fraction X , the helium fraction Y , and/or a “metal” fraction $Z = 1 - X - Y$ that accounts for all the heavier elements (note that in stellar evolution Chapter 5 we indicate this parameter with a lower case z). The connection among the thermodynamic variables is provided by the equation of state (see Section 6.1.1.3). The dynamics of a fluid can be described by three independent partial differential equations, which express the conservation of mass, momentum, and energy.

6.1.1.1 Conservation of Mass

The rate of change of the mass m in some volume V is equal to the rate at which mass flows into or out of V across its surface S :

$$\frac{dm}{dt} = - \int_S \rho \mathbf{v} \cdot d^2\mathbf{S}, \quad (6.1)$$

where $d^2\mathbf{S}$ is the (outward-pointing) vector element of area on S . Writing

$$m = \int_V \rho d^3V, \quad (6.2)$$

and using the divergence theorem on the right side of Equation 6.1, we find

$$\frac{dm}{dt} = \int_V \frac{\partial \rho}{\partial t} d^3V = - \int_V \nabla \cdot (\rho \mathbf{v}) d^3V. \quad (6.3)$$

Because this must be true for any volume V , we immediately obtain the *continuity equation*

$$\frac{\partial \rho}{\partial t} + \nabla \cdot (\rho \mathbf{v}) = 0. \quad (6.4)$$

In the frame of a moving fluid element, we can recast this in terms of the so-called Lagrangian (or comoving) derivative

$$\frac{d}{dt} \equiv \frac{\partial}{\partial t} + \mathbf{v} \cdot \nabla, \quad (6.5)$$

to write

$$\frac{d\rho}{dt} + \rho \nabla \cdot \mathbf{v} = 0. \quad (6.6)$$

6.1.1.2 Conservation of Momentum

Newton's second law (see also Equation 4.1), applied to a fluid element, is simply

$$\rho \frac{d\mathbf{v}}{dt} = \mathbf{F}, \quad (6.7)$$

where $\mathbf{F}$ is the net force per unit volume and “ d ” represents a Lagrangian derivative. In an astrophysical context, the most important forces contributing to the right side of Equation 6.7 are pressure ($\mathbf{F} = -\nabla P$) and gravity ($\mathbf{F} = \rho \mathbf{g} = -\rho \nabla \phi$), so

$$\frac{d\mathbf{v}}{dt} = -\frac{\nabla P}{\rho} + \mathbf{g}. \quad (6.8)$$

Equation 6.8 is known as the *Euler equation*. Other forces (e.g., radiation pressure) can be included in an analogous way. Expanding out the Lagrangian derivative, we find

$$\frac{\partial \mathbf{v}}{\partial t} + \mathbf{v} \cdot \nabla \mathbf{v} = -\frac{\nabla P}{\rho} + \mathbf{g}. \quad (6.9)$$

Note the nonlinear term on the left side, which is the origin of many of the most intractable problems in computational fluid dynamics.

Thus far, we have neglected internal viscous stresses ($\mathbf{F} = \rho \mathbf{f}_{\text{visc}}$) in the Euler equation. By adopting a specific model for including viscous stresses in Equation (6.8) and Equation (6.9), we obtain the *Navier–Stokes equation*. For an incompressible flow, the viscous term can be written

$$\mathbf{f}_{\text{visc}} = \nu \nabla^2 \mathbf{v}, \quad (6.10)$$

where ν is the kinematic viscosity. Although physical viscosities are often too small to be important for large-scale astrophysical flows, similar *artificial viscosity* terms are used in many simulations to suppress short-wavelength features that would otherwise fall below the resolution of the simulation (Von Neumann & Richtmyer, 1950; see Section 6.1.2.2).

6.1.1.3 The Equation of State

We now have four equations (continuity and Euler) involving five fluid quantities: $\mathbf{v}$, ρ , and P . In order to solve this system of equations, we need to close it. In principle, this can be accomplished by adopting an equation of state, which connects ρ and P .

We discussed some possible equations of state in Section 5.1.2.1. Many of the hydrodynamics modules in AMUSE adopt a simple expression of the form

$$P = A(s)\rho^\gamma, \quad (6.11)$$

where γ is the adiabatic index and s is specific entropy. For a monatomic adiabatic ideal gas, $\gamma = \frac{5}{3}$ and s is constant, so P is a function of ρ only. In these cases, the entropy s can only change in shocks (see Section 6.1.2.2), so the flow is adiabatic except when shocks are encountered (Longair, 2011). Sometimes, the index γ is allowed to vary in a density-dependent way to model heating and cooling processes. An isothermal equation of state is modeled simply by forcing the temperature to the desired value at the end of every step.

In reality, however, the true equation of state usually involves other thermodynamic variables, such as temperature $T = T(P, \rho)$ or entropy $s = s(P, \rho)$, and we need additional equations to complete the system. For example, to determine the temperature, we may need to take into account heating and cooling processes in the gas, adding an energy equation to close the set of equations:

$$\Delta e = Q - P\Delta V. \quad (6.12)$$

Here, e is the internal energy per unit mass of the gas, $V = 1/\rho$ is specific volume, and $Q = T\Delta s$ is the net heating, which may have contributions from a variety of sources, such as dissipation, nuclear reactions, cosmic rays, radiative heating and cooling, etc. If the gas cools at a rate $\mathcal{C}$ and is heated at a rate $\mathcal{H}$ (both per unit mass), then the energy equation is

$$\frac{de}{dt} = \mathcal{H} - \mathcal{C} - \frac{P}{\rho} \nabla \cdot \mathbf{v}. \quad (6.13)$$

The simplified equations of state described previously are approximations to the solutions of this equation.

The full equation of state is determined by a number of processes, including the degree of ionization of the medium, its chemistry and composition, the presence of nuclear reactions, heating by cosmic rays, and various radiative processes. The most sophisticated (and costly) treatments model these processes explicitly; the temperature and ionization structure of the gas is determined by equating the heating and cooling rates, or it may be provided by an additional module that calculates the radiative structure of the system (see Chapter 7). Once the temperature T and ionization fraction of the gas have been determined, the pressure P in a star-forming region of density ρ is accurately given by

$$P = \frac{\rho k T}{\mu} + \frac{1}{3} a T^4 \quad (6.14)$$

(cf. Equation 5.16), where k is the Boltzmann constant, μ is the mean molecular weight with the dimension of mass (rather than another common definition in which it is normalized to the mass of hydrogen), and a is the radiation constant (this parameter a has nothing to do with the semi-major axis used in Chapter 4).

6.1.2 Turbulence and Shocks

Fluids are commonly characterized by several dimensionless parameters that describe the overall state of the flow. Two of the most important are the *Reynolds number*, which quantifies the effect of viscosity, and the *Mach number*, which specifies the speed of the flow.

6.1.2.1 Reynolds Number

The Reynolds number Re is defined as the ratio of inertial to viscous forces in a fluid flow. If the flow has length scale L , velocity scale v , and kinematic viscosity ν , then dimensional analysis leads to the expression

$$Re = \frac{vL}{\nu}. \quad (6.15)$$

For low Reynolds number, $Re \ll 1$, viscous forces dominate and the flow is smooth. Fluids with $Re \gg 1$ tend to be turbulent.

For $Re \rightarrow \infty$, the flow behaves as a perfect inviscid fluid ($\nu \rightarrow 0$), but this does not mean that viscosity is irrelevant. Turbulent flow is characterized by motion on a wide range of scales, from the largest to the smallest turbulent eddies. The nonlinear term in the Euler equation sees to it that energy in the large-scale motion with $Re \gg 1$ is systematically transferred to smaller and smaller scales, eventually reaching a scale where $Re \sim 1$ and viscosity can efficiently dissipate the energy. These small scales are often out of reach for numerical simulations, with the result that turbulence acts as an effective viscosity, and high Reynolds number flows are very difficult to model numerically.

6.1.2.2 Mach Number

The Mach number $\mathcal{M}$ is the ratio of the fluid speed to the local sound speed

$$\mathcal{M} = \frac{v}{c_s}. \quad (6.16)$$

For an adiabatic flow, each fluid element has constant entropy and the sound speed is

$$c_s = \sqrt{\frac{\gamma P}{\rho}} = \sqrt{\frac{\gamma k_B T}{\mu}}, \quad (6.17)$$

where γ is the adiabatic index. Thus, the Mach number depends on temperature through c_s . The last equality of Equation 6.17 assumes an ideal gas.

Flows with $\mathcal{M} \lesssim 0.3$ are well described by the simplified incompressible fluid equations. Supersonic flows ($\mathcal{M} > 1$) lead to shock waves. Simply put, given that information in a fluid travels at the speed of sound, material in front of a supersonic disturbance cannot receive any warning before the disturbance arrives, so it can't "get out of the way." As a result, material piles up in front of the disturbance as it propagates through the fluid, forming a shock. Astrophysics abounds with situations in which shock waves can form. Sometimes, as with stellar outflows and supernovae, the disturbance may move at thousands of kilometers per second through the surrounding medium. In other circumstances, such as the collision of two interstellar clouds, the speed of the disturbance may be quite modest—only a few kilometers per second—but still much greater than the local sound speed in a cool gas.

As illustrated in Figure 6.1, in the frame moving with the shock, high-speed material (index 1) flows in from the left while low-speed material (index 2) flows out to the right. In the vicinity of a shock, the Mach number is always $\mathcal{M} > 1$ before the shock and $\mathcal{M} < 1$ behind it. Within this simple one-dimensional geometry, we can write the equations describing the flow in flux-conservative form:

$$\begin{aligned}\frac{\partial \rho}{\partial t} &= -\frac{\partial}{\partial x}(\rho u), \\ \frac{\partial}{\partial t}(\rho u) &= -\frac{\partial}{\partial x}(\rho u^2 + P), \\ \frac{\partial E}{\partial t} &= -\frac{\partial}{\partial x}[u(E + P)],\end{aligned}$$

where u is the fluid speed and $E = \rho e + \frac{1}{2}\rho u^2$ is the total energy density of the fluid, with e the specific internal energy.

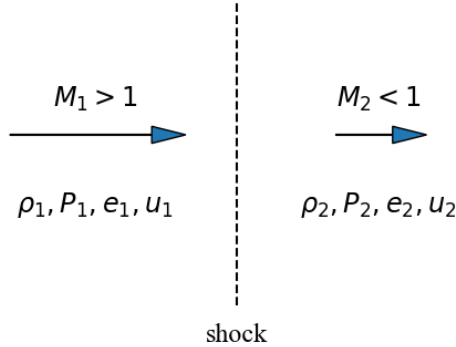


Figure 6.1: Geometry of a plane shock wave, in the frame of the shock.

Integrating these equations across the shock discontinuity and assuming a steady state, for a stationary shock in its frame of reference, we obtain the *Rankine–Hugoniot conditions* (Rankine, 1870; Hugoniot, 1885), expressing conservation of mass, momentum, and energy across the shock:

$$\begin{aligned}\rho_1 u_1 &= \rho_2 u_2, \\ \rho_1 u_1^2 + P_1 &= \rho_2 u_2^2 + P_2, \\ \rho_1 u_1 \left(e_1 + \frac{1}{2}u_1^2 + P_1/\rho_1 \right) &= \rho_2 u_2 \left(e_2 + \frac{1}{2}u_2^2 + P_2/\rho_2 \right)\end{aligned}$$

Note that we can use the first condition to simplify the third and give Bernoulli's principle (Bernoulli, 1738): $e_1 + 0.5u_1^2 + P/\rho_1 = e_2 + 0.5u_2^2 + P/\rho_2$.

These equations can be solved for the jump in various quantities of interest across the shock, expressed here in terms of the pre-shock Mach number $\mathcal{M}_1 = u_1/c_{s1}$ (Landau & Lifshitz, 1959):

$$\begin{aligned}\frac{\rho_2}{\rho_1} &= \frac{u_1}{u_2} = \frac{(\gamma+1)\mathcal{M}_1^2}{(\gamma-1)\mathcal{M}_1^2+2}, \\ \frac{P_2}{P_1} &= \frac{2\gamma\mathcal{M}_1^2-(\gamma-1)}{\gamma+1}, \\ \frac{T_2}{T_1} &= \frac{[2\gamma\mathcal{M}_1^2-(\gamma-1)][(\gamma-1)\mathcal{M}_1^2+2]}{(\gamma+1)^2\mathcal{M}_1}, \\ \mathcal{M}_2^2 &= \frac{2+(\gamma-1)\mathcal{M}_1^2}{2\gamma\mathcal{M}_1^2-(\gamma-1)}.\end{aligned}$$

The thickness of the shock is ultimately determined by the viscosity of the fluid (see Equation 6.10), which turns pre-shock kinetic energy into post-shock thermal energy and entropy. For systems without large-scale viscosity or explicit heating and cooling mechanisms, shocks are the only regions where the gas can increase its entropy. In many astrophysical contexts, the fluid viscosity is very low, so the shock is well-approximated as a discontinuous jump in fluid properties from left to right, as just described. However, in simulations, numerical and artificial viscosity can exceed the true physical viscosity by many orders of magnitude, spreading out the shock and limiting the resolution of the flow.

6.1.3 Hydrodynamical Time Scales

To further develop our intuition, we define some time scales relevant to astrophysical phenomena. In Table 6.1, we provide an overview of various hydrodynamical regimes and their characteristic parameters, such as temperature and density. The range of parameters spans many orders of magnitude, and the physics may vary considerably across this range of astronomical objects, but practically all of these can be (and are) addressed with the hydrodynamical models described in this chapter.

6.1.3.1 Free-fall Time Scale

As with a self-gravitating stellar system, we can define a collapse (or free-fall time scale for a gaseous cloud. This time scale can be written

$$t_{\text{ff}} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{G\rho}}. \quad (6.18)$$

Note that, because $\rho \sim M/R^3$, this is essentially the dynamical time scale defined in Equation 4.5. For a $1 M_\odot$ molecular cloud in a cubic parsec volume, $\rho \simeq 7 \times 10^{-23} \text{ g/cm}^3$ and $t_{\text{ff}} \simeq 15 \text{ Myr}$.

Table 6.1: Physical characteristics of some typical regimes in which hydrodynamics plays a role. Estimates of the relevant fundamental parameters are given, including the typical temperature (T), number density (n), scale height (h), and the state of the gas. For the circumstellar disks we adopt the mid-plane densities and radial scales.

Typical environment	T [K]	n [cm ⁻³]	h [pc]	state of hydrogen
cold neutral medium	50–100	20–50	100–300	atomic
warm neutral medium	10 ⁴	0.2–0.5	300–400	atomic
warm ionized medium	8000	0.2–0.5	10 ³	ionized
H II regions	8000	0.2–0.5	70	ionized
stellar coronæ	10 ⁶ –10 ⁷	10 ⁻⁴ –10 ⁻²	10 ⁻⁷	ionized
stellar interiors	10 ⁴ –10 ⁷	10 ²⁹	10 ⁻⁹	ionized
molecular clouds	10–20	10 ² –10 ⁶	80	molecular
circumstellar disks	3000–7000	10 ¹¹	10 ⁻⁵ –10 ⁻³	molecular

The self-gravity of a gas is often ignored in hydrodynamical simulations, particularly when the gravity is dominated by another object, as in a relatively low-mass circumstellar disk, or when the gas is extremely hot and expanding, as in an expanding supernova shell. In other circumstances, of course, such as star formation, self-gravity is critical.

6.1.3.2 Sound-crossing Time Scale

The sound-crossing time scale of a region of gas with length scale R is

$$t_{\text{sound}} = \frac{R}{c_s}, \quad (6.19)$$

where the sound speed c_s is given by Equation 6.17. For a star in virial equilibrium (see Section 5.1.1.3), $t_{\text{sound}} \approx t_{\text{ff}}$.

6.1.3.3 Viscous Time Scale

We can estimate the shortest unstable wavelength of a flow if we know the kinematic viscosity ν . The time scale on which a disturbance of wavenumber k is damped is

$$t_{\text{visc}} \sim \frac{1}{k^2 \nu}. \quad (6.20)$$

This can be seen by estimating $|\mathbf{v}|/|\mathbf{f}_{\text{visc}}|$ in Equations 6.8 and 6.10, or by writing $L = 1/k$, $v = L/t_{\text{visc}}$ and requiring that the Reynolds number $Re \sim 1$. Stabilization occurs if this time scale is shorter than the growth time scale of an instability. Comparing with the instability growth times given by Equations 6.25 and 6.21, we see that viscosity results in an upper limit on the unstable wavenumber k .

6.1.4 Hydrodynamical Instabilities

Hydrodynamical flows are subject to a number of instabilities, the best known being the Kelvin–Helmholtz, Rayleigh–Taylor, and Jeans instabilities. The first two operate in

(for example) boundary layers between fluids; the second and third occur in external or self-gravitating potentials, respectively. The growth of these instabilities is eventually arrested by viscosity, the effect of which increases as spatial scales become small and velocities become high.

6.1.4.1 Rayleigh–Taylor Instability

The Rayleigh–Taylor instability arises when a dense fluid (density ρ_1) lies above a less dense fluid (density ρ_2) in a gravitational field (which defines “above”). The growth time scale for a mode with wavenumber k in a uniform field g is

$$t_{\text{RT}} = \left(\frac{\rho_1 - \rho_2}{\rho_1 + \rho_2} gk \right)^{-1/2} \quad (6.21)$$

The instability is driven by the fractional difference between the two densities. The time scale $(gk)^{-1/2}$ in Equation 6.21 is the time needed for a point on the boundary to accelerate (with acceleration g) through a distance comparable to the wavelength $(1/k)$. Shorter wavelengths grow more quickly, and they become nonlinear sooner, but the long wavelengths are ultimately crucial for mixing the fluids.

6.1.4.2 Shear and Kelvin–Helmholtz Instabilities

The Kelvin–Helmholtz instability arises in the interface layer between fluids with different velocities. Consider a fluid of constant mean density ρ , which is subject to shear due to the presence of another fluid with which it shares a boundary at $z = 0$. Near the boundary, the relative flow velocity is

$$\mathbf{v} = v(z) \mathbf{e}_x = Sz \mathbf{e}_x, \quad (6.22)$$

where $S = dv/dz|_0$ is the local shearing rate of the fluid. Equation 6.22 can be viewed as a first-order Taylor expansion of the actual shear flow near $z = 0$.

Now consider two parcels of fluid, one at $z = 0$ and the other at $z = \varepsilon$, where ε is small. The kinetic energy (per unit volume) in the two parcels is

$$E = \frac{1}{2}\rho v(0)^2 + \frac{1}{2}\rho v(\varepsilon)^2 = \frac{1}{2}\rho S^2 \varepsilon^2 \quad (6.23)$$

Moving in the frame of reference of the fluid at $z = 0$, the momentum of the lower parcel is zero, while a parcel in the upper layer has a momentum (per unit volume) of $\rho v = \rho S \varepsilon$. Now imagine switching the two parcels, so the top one becomes the bottom and vice versa, mixing and equalizing their momenta. If total momentum is conserved in the process, then the momentum of each of the two parcels becomes $\frac{1}{2}\rho S \varepsilon$ and they both move with the average speed $\frac{1}{2}S \varepsilon$. The kinetic energy of the switched parcels is then

$$E_s = \frac{1}{4}\rho S^2 \varepsilon^2. \quad (6.24)$$

Thus, the new flow consisting of the two switched parcels has lower energy than the original: the difference is $\Delta E = E - E_s = 1/4\rho S^2 \varepsilon^2 > 0$. This energy is available for amplifying initial perturbations and driving instabilities. This is the fundamental

reason why shear instabilities are so common: the shear itself is a reservoir of kinetic energy that can be used to drive the instability. Figure 6.2 presents an actual example of observed Kelvin–Helmholtz instability.



Figure 6.2: Kelvin-Helmholtz instability observed in the atmosphere of Jupiter, as photographed by the *Juno* mission on 2017 December 16 at 12:43 EST at a distance of 13,345 km. Image by NASA/JPL-Caltech/SwRI/MSSS/Gerald Eichstädt/Seán Doran with permission.

If gravity can be neglected, then the shear flow is demonstrably unstable on all length scales. For a shear flow involving fluids of densities ρ_1 and ρ_2 and velocities v_1 and v_2 , the growth time scale for wavenumber k is (Bradt, 2014)

$$t_{\text{KH}} = \frac{\rho_1 + \rho_2}{\sqrt{\rho_1 \rho_2}} \frac{1}{k \Delta v}. \quad (6.25)$$

Here, $\Delta v \equiv |v_1 - v_2|$ and $\lambda = 2\pi/k$. When the densities are comparable, $t_{\text{KH}} \sim 1/k\Delta v$, so the growth time scale is comparable to the time taken for the fluids to move one wavelength relative to one another. Again, the shortest wavelengths grow most rapidly. In Section 6.6.2, we present an example to test the AMUSE hydrodynamics solvers on a Kelvin–Helmholtz instability.

6.1.4.3 Jeans Instability

The Rayleigh–Taylor and Kelvin–Helmholtz instabilities appear along the boundaries between fluids. The Jeans instability can arise in a single fluid, so long as the fluid is sufficiently dense.

If the freefall time scale t_{ff} (Equation 6.18) in the fluid exceeds the sound-crossing time scale t_{sound} (Equation 6.19), pressure forces can overcome gravity and the fluid is stable against small perturbations. However, if $t_{\text{sound}} > t_{\text{ff}}$, the fluid is unstable against gravitational collapse. The resulting length scale is called the Jeans length and can be estimated by conflating Equations 6.18 and 6.19, which results in

$$\lambda_J = \frac{2\pi}{k_J} \sim \frac{c_s}{\sqrt{G\rho}}. \quad (6.26)$$

A more careful analysis of the collapse, based on a study of the stability of one-dimensional sound waves (see [Binney & Tremaine, 1987](#)), gives

$$\lambda_J = c_s \sqrt{\frac{\pi}{G\rho}}. \quad (6.27)$$

All scales larger than λ_J are unstable against gravitational collapse, whereas smaller scales are stable. An associated mass, called the Jeans mass, is conventionally taken to be the mass contained within a sphere with diameter equal to the Jeans length:

$$M_J = \frac{4}{3}\pi\rho(\frac{1}{2}\lambda_J)^3 = \frac{\pi^{5/2}}{6} \frac{c_s^3}{\sqrt{G^3\rho}}. \quad (6.28)$$

For a typical dense molecular cloud with temperature 10 K and density 10^3 hydrogen molecules cm^{-3} , the sound speed is $c_s = 260 \text{ m s}^{-1}$, so $\lambda_J = 1 \text{ pc}$ and $M_J = 26 M_\odot$.

6.1.5 Physics of the Integrator

6.1.5.1 Underlying Assumptions

Several assumptions must be made about the state of the fluid, depending on accuracy requirements and our knowledge of the underlying physics. We mention here just some of the most important assumptions made in astronomical fluid dynamical simulations.

1. **Fluid approximation.** As mentioned previously, to derive the fluid equations (Equations 6.9 and 6.8) solved by all of the hydrodynamics modules in AMUSE, it is necessary to assume that we can find a length scale that is small compared to any scale of interest, but large enough to contain sufficient particles for density, temperature, etc. to be well-defined. For example, imagine a giant molecular cloud of mass $10^4 M_\odot$ and radius 3 pc. The mean density is $\rho \approx 6.0 \times 10^{-21} \text{ g cm}^{-3}$. If the composition is pure molecular hydrogen, $m_{\text{H}_2} = 3.35 \times 10^{-24} \text{ g}$, then a cubic meter contains 1.8×10^{12} molecules, more than enough to accurately define local thermodynamic quantities. At the same time, 1 m is far smaller than any scale of interest for studies of interstellar gas flow or star formation.

Note that, even if the gas can be represented well as a continuous fluid, a similar problem recurs in simulation methods that treat the fluid as an ensemble of particles (see Section 6.2.1). It is important to ensure that the number of particles is large enough that the Poisson noise introduced by their finite number is small, so that the particles accurately represent the underlying distribution function. In principle, we could use a huge number of small particles to represent a cloud, but this would be numerically infeasible. However, if we make the particles too massive, we run the risk of averaging too much, thereby artificially smoothing the solution. One of the most important ingredients of hydrodynamical simulations is choosing the proper resolution to address the problem of interest.

2. **Classical fluid.** All of the AMUSE hydrodynamics modules assume that the fluid at any point can be described by its velocity, temperature, and composition, and that quantum mechanical and relativistic effects can be ignored.

3. **Local thermodynamic equilibrium.** We assume that every fluid element is in local thermodynamic equilibrium—that is, all particles in the element can interact locally and reach equilibrium with each other (see Section 5.1.2). As a consequence, there is only one degree of freedom: the temperature. This assumption is violated in shocks, in which the temperature is formally discontinuous (as are the related thermodynamic quantities). All AMUSE modules contain prescriptions to handle such sharp features, either by incorporating explicit shock-capturing schemes or by spreading shocks out over a few resolution elements.

All of these assumptions are built into the hydrodynamics modules in AMUSE. It is probably worth your time to check that they actually apply before launching into a large-scale AMUSE simulation.

6.2 Hydrodynamics in AMUSE

The hydrodynamics modules in AMUSE can be divided into two broad categories, each having its own fan base and sets of advantages and disadvantages. Experts will argue (interminably) the merits of each. Here, we try to take an agnostic view.

6.2.1 Types of Hydrodynamics Code

1. **Lagrangian methods: SPH.** In the Lagrangian description of a fluid flow, we follow the motion of a fluid element as described by Equation 6.8. One strength of Lagrangian methods is that they preserve Galilean invariance, i.e., the laws of motion are the same in all inertial frames.

In most numerical implementations of this approach, the fluid is represented by particles. Each particle represents a finite mass of the fluid; density and other thermodynamic quantities are computed by kernel estimation from nearby particles. Because each particle may be thought of as being smoothed out over some region, these methods are generically referred to as Smoothed Particle Hydrodynamics, or SPH. The amount of smoothing determines the accuracy and resolution of the method, so it must be chosen carefully. Larger smoothing means that many particles contribute to the density at any given point, reducing statistical fluctuations but also decreasing resolution. Interactions among particles include gravity, implemented much as in an N -body code (see Section 4.2), as well as pressure forces due to a particle's neighbors.

SPH codes are relatively straightforward to implement. The use of particles naturally makes them well-suited to astrophysical phenomena involving complex morphologies and/or poorly defined boundaries. They tend to be very stable, although the results can be adversely affected by noise. One significant problem is the lack of a natural prescription for dissipation and diffusion, which are generally controlled by free parameters. Because they put the particles where the mass is, SPH codes generally provide a poor description of low-density regions in a flow.

The smoothing formulation leads to difficulties in resolving environments with high density or temperature contrasts. In particular, shocks may be difficult to resolve, although there are many variations on the basic SPH method in which such complex phenomena can be handled effectively (e.g., Monaghan & Gingold, 1983). Variations and extensions to the fundamental SPH description allow for the study of complex processes, including, for example, magnetohydrodynamics, turbulence, and various relativistic effects (Iwasaki & Inutsuka, 2011; Price *et al.*, 2018).

2. **Eulerian methods: Grid-based and finite volume schemes.** Instead of following the motion of individual fluid elements, the equations of motion (as expressed in Equation 6.9) can instead be solved on a grid. Most high-performance Eulerian grid-based codes rely on so-called Godunov (1959) schemes, which solve the underlying partial differential equations using a conservative finite-volume method at each inter-cell boundary. The original Godunov method was accurate only to first order in space and time, but higher-order methods have since been developed (van Leer, 1979; Colella & Woodward, 1984), and are now the norm.

In the simplest implementation of an Eulerian scheme, a fixed three-dimensional grid is imposed on the system and the fluid dynamical equations are solved on the grid vertices. The geometry can vary from run to run, but it remains fixed at run time. Common grid choices include Cartesian, spherical, cylindrical, or toroidal coordinates. Ideally, the problem under study has some symmetry, allowing it to map naturally onto some grid topology, and this symmetry should not change greatly during the simulation.

In contrast to Lagrangian methods, grid-based methods are not Galilean-invariant, because the algorithm to calculate the fluxes has preferred directions. This may pose a problem when studying Kelvin–Helmholtz or other shear instabilities. For such studies, grid codes tend to give different solutions for the same relative velocity between the two layers when the entire system is moving (see Section 6.1.4.2). This can be solved (at considerable expense in computer resources) by reducing the truncation error in the flux calculation algorithm and increasing resolution until the hydrodynamical instabilities are resolved (Godunov & Kulikov, 2014). This is rarely done because of its computational cost. As a consequence, Eulerian fixed-grid codes are not really suitable for studying discontinuities and multi-phase media. These problems seem to be solved with moving-mesh methods, but further study is required.

The fixed-grid topology allows grid-based hydrodynamics codes to perform excellently on large parallel architectures. In addition, it is relatively straightforward to extend the fluid dynamical equations to include radiative transfer, magnetic fields, or relativistic effects. Despite the resolution problems introduced by adopting a fixed grid, these methods are still quite popular.

Fixed-grid methods can be improved by allowing the grid to be refined, depending on local resolution requirements. The resulting adaptive mesh refinement

(AMR) codes are suited particularly well to addressing the development of discontinuities, such as shocks and gravitational collapse, whose appearance in a simulation is hard to predict in advance (MacNeice *et al.*, 2000; Adams, 2014). The main disadvantages of grid-based methods are their relatively large memory requirements and the complexity of coding and optimization. In addition, the grid topology may be reflected in the solution, and boundary conditions may produce unwanted artifacts in the flow.

3. **Unstructured mesh schemes.** Particle- and grid-based methods are slowly being superseded by moving-mesh methods that solve the fluid dynamical equations on unstructured grids that evolve with the fluid (Robertson *et al.*, 2010; Springel, 2010). In many ways, these methods combine the best properties of Lagrangian and Eulerian methods. They are efficiently parallelizable by domain decomposition, and are suitable for solving systems with steep temperature and/or density gradients. A major advantage of these methods is that the solution is independent of grid structure, removing one of the major disadvantages of AMR methods.

Table 6.2 lists the most important hydrodynamics codes currently available in AMUSE. Here, we draw a distinction between particle-based (TreeSPH), fixed grid (grid), adaptive mesh refinement (AMR) codes and moving mesh (MM). Each of the codes is parallelized, because hydrodynamics is expensive in terms of computing time, and high resolution requires considerable amounts of computer memory. AMUSE further contains an interface to FLASH (Fryxell *et al.*, 2000), which requires registration or permission to use. These codes are not routinely distributed with AMUSE, but the interface is available within the repository. In our estimation, the best codes to use are **Fi**, or **Phantom**. Ideally, we would like to interface with **BonsaiSPH** (Bedorf & Portegies Zwart, 2020), but we still have not resolved how to address multiple GPUs across a distributed memory machine in the AMUSE interface.

We can run a hydrodynamics code in AMUSE in much the same way as an N -body or stellar evolution simulation would be run. Because the two main algorithms (grid and SPH) used to solve the fluid equations differ so greatly, the user must decide in advance which one to use. Ideally, we would like to be able to switch back and forth between the two approaches as needed. Regrettably, that is not currently possible in AMUSE because we do not know how to uniquely convert a particle distribution to an adaptive grid, and generating a low-noise particle distribution from an adaptive mesh is challenging. The SPH interface is developed better and used most widely, so most of the discussion that follows will assume that choice. In Section 6.2.3, we will present some simple examples using grid codes.

6.2.2 Smoothed Particle Hydrodynamics

Code example 6.1 presents a simple function for setting up and solving a hydrodynamics problem in AMUSE. This script doesn't do much, but in the next few paragraphs we will demonstrate that, as with gravity and stellar evolution, it is possible to do some interesting experiments with just hydrodynamics.

Table 6.2: Hydrodynamics codes distributed within AMUSE. Each of these codes compiles by default with an adiabatic equation of state. An isothermal equation of state is implemented, but requires the code to be recompiled, except for `Fi` where it can be set as a code parameter. The global code characteristics are indicated in the third columns, where `TreeSPH` indicates the SPH codes for which the interacting forces are calculated using a tree-code, `grid` and `AMR` refer to cartesian or refined grid methods, and `MM` to moving mesh. The last column gives the available boundary conditions accessible directly from AMUSE: "cont," "inflow," "interface," "outflow," "periodic," and "reflective" (see §6.2.3). For `Athena3D` see also <https://trac.princeton.edu/Athena/wiki/AthenaEqns>. References: 1: [Springel \(2000, 2005\)](#); 2: [Hernquist & Katz \(1989\)](#); [Pelupessy et al. \(2004\)](#); [Gerritsen & Icke \(1997\)](#); 3: [Price et al. \(2018\)](#); 4: [Mellema et al. \(1991\)](#); 5: [Gardiner & Stone \(2005, 2008\)](#); [Stone et al. \(2008, 2010\)](#); 6: [Meliani et al. \(2007\)](#); [Keppens et al. \(2012\)](#); [van der Holst et al. \(2012\)](#); [Porth et al. \(2014\)](#); 8: [Fryxell et al. \(2000\)](#); 9: [Pakmor et al. \(2016\)](#).

name	ref.	type of code	language	parallel	boundaries
Gadget-2	1	TreeSPH	C	yes	ciopr
Fi	2	TreeSPH	F95	yes	ciopr
Phantom	3	TreeSPH	F95	yes	ciopr
Capreole	4	grid	F95	yes	--iopr
Athena3D	5	AMR	C	yes	--iopr
mpiAMRVAC	6	AMR	F95	yes	--iopr
FLASH	8	AMR	F90	yes	--i-pr
Arepo	9	MM	C	yes	ciopr

The function first sets up a virialized gas [Plummer \(1911\)](#) sphere of specified mass and radius, realized as `N` particles (see Section 3.2):

```
converter = nbody_system.nbody_to_si(Mtot , Rvir)
gas = new_plummer_gas_model(N, convert_nbody=converter)
```

Note that, because the function `new_plummer_gas_model` is written in N -body units, we need a `converter` (see Section 2.3) to define the physical units used. Most hydrodynamics solvers work in CGS units, unlike the N -body and stellar units used in previous chapters. However, as discussed in Section 2.3, AMUSE keeps track of such details, so we don't have to do it explicitly.

We initialize the SPH code `Gadget2` as our hydrodynamics code and commit the gas particles, much as we did in Chapter 4:

```
hydro = Gadget2(converter)
hydro.gas_particles.add_particles(gas)
```

We are now ready to evolve the hydrodynamics solver to some end time `t_end`:

```
hydro.evolve_model(t_end)
```

Eventually, we could dump the data to a file with the name `filename`

```
write_set_to_file(hydro.particles, filename)
```

We might improve this hydrodynamical calculation by running it in small time increments and printing diagnostics after each, just as we did for the gravity solver (Code example 4.1). Hydrodynamics simulations are often used in this way to make animations. Many of these can be quite instructive, but beware of convincing-looking animations that actually present erroneous results. Validating results is an important

```

14 def hydro_minimal(
15     number_of_particles=100,
16     total_mass=1 | units.MSun,
17     virial_radius=1 | units.RSun,
18     time_end=6 | units.hour,
19 ):
20     converter = nbody_system.nbody_to_si(total_mass, virial_radius)
21     gas = new_plummer_gas_model(number_of_particles, convert_nbody=converter)
22
23     hydro = Gadget2(converter)
24     hydro.gas_particles.add_particles(gas)
25     energy_total_init = (
26         hydro.kinetic_energy + hydro.potential_energy + hydro.thermal_energy
27     )
28     hydro.evolve_model(time_end)
29     write_set_to_file(hydro.particles, "hydro.amuse")
30
31     energy_kinetic = hydro.kinetic_energy
32     energy_potential = hydro.potential_energy
33     energy_thermal = hydro.thermal_energy
34     energy_total = energy_kinetic + energy_potential + energy_thermal
35     virial_ratio = (energy_kinetic + energy_thermal) / energy_potential
36     energy_difference = (energy_total_init - energy_total) / energy_total
37     com = hydro.gas_particles.center_of_mass()
38     print(
39         f"T= {hydro.get_time()} M= {hydro.gas_particles.mass.sum()} "
40         f"E= {energy_total} Q= {virial_ratio} "
41         f"dE= {energy_difference} CoM= {com.in_(units.RSun)}"
42     )
43
44     hydro.stop()

```

Code example 6.1: Minimal routine for evolving a Plummer gas cloud of mass M_{tot} and virial radius R_{vir} to some end time t_{end} . Note that we left out the various `import` statements. The full example can be found in `amuse.examples.hydro_minimal`.

but difficult aspect of these simulations.

6.2.3 Grid-based Methods

Setting up a grid code is not much different from setting up an SPH code, except that defining the boundary conditions and generating the initial conditions are somewhat more elaborate. The fundamental calling sequence is similar to the SPH version. First, we declare the converter and start the code:

```

converter = nbody_system.nbody_to_si(1|units.MSun, 1|units.RSun)
hydro_code = Athena(converter, number_of_workers=16)

```

Grid-based hydro codes parallelize quite well, and the calculations are often computationally intensive. We therefore recommend always running them in parallel. In this example, we run the code using 16 cores.

We can tune the working of the hydrodynamics solver by specifying some of the fundamental parameters, such as the adiabatic index, for which we adopt $\gamma = 5/3$ for

the ideal monatomic gas. Another important parameter is the Courant–Friedrichs–Lewy condition, which is used to control the convergence while solving the hyperbolic partial differential equations in the finite-difference scheme (see [Courant *et al.*, 1928](#)), for which we choose a value of 0.3.

```
hydro_code.parameters.gamma = 5/3
hydro_code.parameters.courant_number=0.3
```

More detail on the important parameters used by this AMUSE module (and others) are presented in [Appendix A](#).

We further specify the grid resolution in each of the three Cartesian coordinates, and the length of the computational domain

```
hydro_code.parameters.nx = resolution
hydro_code.parameters.ny = resolution
hydro_code.parameters.nz = resolution

hydro_code.parameters.length_x = grid_size
hydro_code.parameters.length_y = grid_size
hydro_code.parameters.length_z = grid_size
```

Here `resolution` is an integer value, and `grid_size` represents the width of a grid-cell (with units). We subsequently specify the boundary conditions, which are attributes of the running hydro code and can be set as parameters. For example, to apply open outflow boundary conditions along the Cartesian coordinates,

```
hydro_code.x_boundary_conditions = ("outflow", "outflow")
hydro_code.y_boundary_conditions = ("outflow", "outflow")
hydro_code.z_boundary_conditions = ("outflow", "outflow")
```

Referring to the left and right boundaries in the appropriate axes. Alternatives to the "outflow" boundary condition are "cont", "inflow", "interface", "periodic", and "reflective", although not all of these may be defined for each of the available hydrodynamics solvers in AMUSE. The keywords refer to the different ways in which grid boundaries are handled, and they can be set separately for each of the three Cartesian coordinates. In this case, we opt for "outflow" boundary conditions. [Table 6.2](#) presents a brief overview of the boundary conditions supported by each code; [Appendix A](#) gives more detail on the boundary conditions.

After the hydrodynamics solver has been initialized, we construct the grid, which is created with a specified geometry and filled with distributions of density, momentum, and energy. Initializing a three-dimensional grid can be realized with the built-in function from the `datamodel` package

```
from amuse.datamodel import new_regular_grid
grid = new_regular_grid((100, 100, 100), [10, 10, 10] | units.RSun)
```

which generates a three-dimensional grid of 10^6 ($= 100 \times 100 \times 100$) cells, with total lengths of $10 R_{\odot}$ in each of the three Cartesian coordinates (the computational domain runs from zero to $10 R_{\odot}$ in each). Densities (`grid.rho`), energies (`grid.energy`), and momenta (`grid.momentum`) can then be set in the individual grid cells. Global grid

properties can be added to each of the grid cells in much the same way as we add properties to a particle set, e.g.,

```
grid.rho = 1.e-10 * units.MSun/units.RSun**3
```

Other parameters can be set similarly.

Filling the grid with useful initial conditions is complicated, and only a limited number of built-in functions exist to assist you in the task. One of these functions is `fill_grid_with_spherical_cloud`, which adds a homogeneous spherical density distribution to `grid`. Thus, to add a homogeneous spherical cloud with density equal to the mean solar density,

```
from amuse.ext import cloud
cloud.fill_grid_with_spherical_cloud(
    grid,
    center = [5.0, 5.0, 5.0] | units.RSun,
    radius = 1 | units.RSun,
    rho = 1.0 | units.MSun / units.RSun**3,
    rhovx = 0.0 | units.kg / (units.s * units.m**2),
    rhovy = 0.0 | units.kg / (units.s * units.m**2),
    rhovz = 0.0 | units.kg / (units.s * units.m**2),
    energy = 1.e+40 | units.erg / units.RSun**3
)
```

Sometimes, one needs to add additional attributes, such as chemical composition or magnetic fields, to the grid. This can be accomplished by adding a vector attribute to each of the grid cells. The function `add_global_vector_attribute` adds a vector quantity to a local particle set or grid. For example, to add a three-dimensional vector called `composition` with components X, Y, and Z describing the composition in hydrogen, helium, and metals (as in stellar evolution, Section 5.2.1, where according to the common terminology one uses lower cases for the same variables.), we could write:

```
grid.add_global_vector_attribute("composition", ["X", "Y", "Z"])
grid.composition = (0.7, 0.29, 0.01)
```

The grid itself is eventually copied to the running hydro code using a channel.

```
channel = grid.new_channel_to(hydro_code.grid)
channel.copy()
```

Running the hydrodynamics solver to some end time `t_end` is no more elaborate than running any other code:

```
channel = hydro_code.grid.new_channel_to(grid)
dt = t_end/10.
while hydro_code.model_time < t_end:
    hydro_code.evolve_model(hydro_code.model_time + dt)
    channel.copy()
    write_set_to_file(grid, filename, ``amuse'`)
hydro_code.stop()
```

A fully working example of this procedure can be found in

`amuse.examples.supernova_grid.`

6.2.4 Managing Shocks and Discontinuities

Efficient and accurate treatment of shocks is a key component of all modern hydrodynamics simulation codes (see Section 6.1.2.2). Simply put, finite-difference schemes don't handle discontinuities well, and when the discontinuity is too steep (spread over too many resolution elements), a shock wave produces unphysical density oscillations behind the advancing front.

Simple finite-difference codes (like the SPH codes in AMUSE), rely on artificial viscosity to prevent the steep gradients and unphysical oscillations associated with shocks. There are many variations, but the basic idea goes back to [Von Neumann & Richtmyer \(1950\)](#), who replaced the pressure P in the Euler (Equation (6.8)) and energy (Equation (6.13)) equations by $P + q$, where

$$q = \begin{cases} \alpha \rho h^2 (\nabla \cdot \mathbf{v})^2, & \nabla \cdot \mathbf{v} < 0 \\ 0, & \nabla \cdot \mathbf{v} > 0. \end{cases} \quad (6.29)$$

Here, h is the particle smoothing length in an SPH calculation or the local grid spacing in a grid code. The method artificially increases the local pressure in regions of strongly convergent flows to limit large density gradients. The parameter $\alpha \sim 1$ is tuned to spread shocks out over a few (4–5) resolution elements, maintaining stability but losing precision.

More sophisticated *shock-capturing schemes* (incorporated into the grid-based AMUSE modules) leverage our knowledge of basic 1-D shock physics to model the flux of mass, momentum, and energy from one grid cell to the next (see Section 6.6.1). These schemes provide much better resolution of fine structure, albeit at the expense of a considerable increase in code complexity. Comparable schemes have been introduced into the SPH formalism ([Inutsuka, 2002](#); [Murante et al., 2011](#)), with only limited success.

6.2.5 Initializing a Grid from a Particle Distribution

Sometimes it is easier to generate a particle distribution with certain properties and then convert it to a grid. For example, we might start by generating an initial Plummer sphere (see Chapter 4) particle distribution, as described in Section 6.2.2. We can then convert this distribution to a grid by using the function `convert_SPH_to_grid`:

```
from amuse.ext.sph_to_grid import convert_SPH_to_grid
sph_code = setup_sph_code(Fi, N, Rvir, rho, u)
grid = convert_SPH_to_grid(sph_code, (100, 100, 100))
```

Here, we adopt the SPH code `Fi` with `N` particles distributed in a sphere with radius `Rvir`, density `rho`, and internal energy `u`. The SPH code is then used to fill the grid cells from the particle distribution. Bear in mind that some AMUSE data structures naturally map onto grids. For example, the one-dimensional internal structure of a star in a Henyey stellar evolution code (see Section 6.2) is easily translated into a three-dimensional grid for use in a hydro code.

Figure 6.3 presents the result of a grid-based hydrodynamical simulation of an exploding core-halo “star”. Initially, the star had a central $1.4 M_{\odot}$ core, of radius $0.1 R_{\odot}$, surrounded by a homogeneous spherical halo of mass $3 M_{\odot}$ and radius $1 R_{\odot}$. We then uniformly injected 10^{51} erg of energy into the core, causing it to explode. The adopted grid resolution was fixed at 256^3 . The symmetric blobs visible at the corners are artifacts of this Cartesian grid.

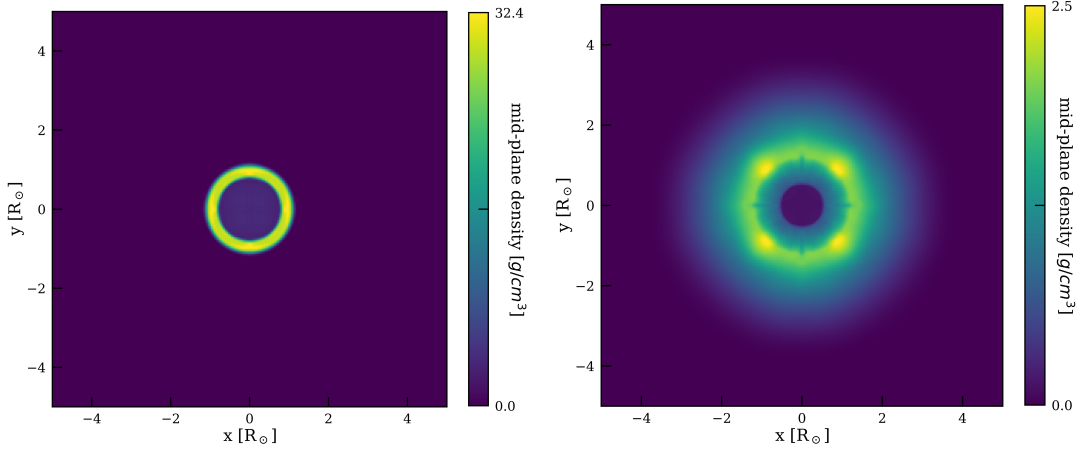


Figure 6.3: Mid-plane density distribution of a $4 M_{\odot}$ core-halo “star” whose $1.4 M_{\odot}$ core explodes at time 0 with an energy of 10^{51} erg. Resolution is $256 \times 256 \times 256$ grid cells. The two snapshots are taken at 100s (left) and 300s (right) after the explosion. The calculation was performed using *Athena*. The figure was made using the script `amuse.examples.supernova_grid`; it takes a couple of hours to run on a laptop.

Figure 6.4 presents the result of an SPH calculation using exactly the same initial conditions as for the grid calculation just described Figure 6.3. The presentation in Figure 6.4 is slightly different from Figure 6.3, because generating an image from a particle distribution entails interpolating the particle densities onto the image plane, rather than simply taking slices from a grid, but the two images show interesting similarities and discrepancies. In this case, we first performed the calculation using one script, then wrote the data to a file, and later made the plot using another script.

To make the figure, we first construct a regular grid of x - and y -coordinates:

```
def setup_grid(N):
    x,y = numpy.indices((N+1,N+1))
    x = L*(x.flatten()-N/2.)/N
    y = L*(y.flatten()-N/2.)/N
    z = 0.*x
    vx = 0.*x
    vy = 0.*x
    vz = 0.*x
    x = units.parsec(x)
    y = units.parsec(y)
    z = units.parsec(z)
    vx = units.kms(vx)
    vy = units.kms(vy)
    vz = units.kms(vz)
    return x, y, z, vx, vy, vz
```

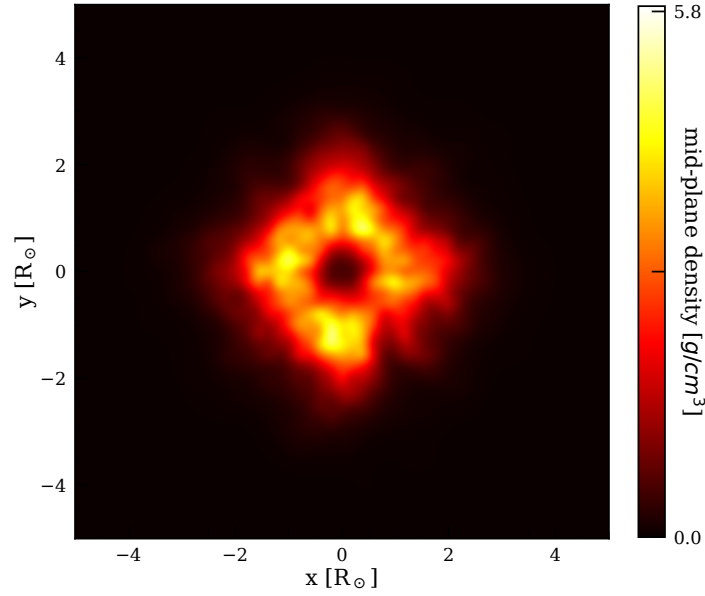


Figure 6.4: Projected density distribution of the same core-halo exploding object as in Figure 6.3. This run was performed using the SPH code `Gadget2` with 10^5 equal-mass particles. The image is taken 300 s after the injection of 10^{51} erg of energy into the core. The data to make the figure were generated using the script `amuse.examples.supernova_sph`, requiring a few minutes to run; the figure itself was made using `amuse.examples.plot_supernova_sph`.

and fill this using interpolated values from a running SPH code:

```
def make_hydromap_and_show_picture(sph_particles, N=100, L=10):
    hydro = Gadget2(converter)
    hydro.gas_particles.add_particles(sph_particles)
    x, y, z, vx, vy, vz = setup_grid(N)
    rho, rhovx, rhovy, rhovz, rhoe = hydro.get_hydro_state_at_point(x,y,z,vx,vy,vz)
    rho = rhoe.reshape((N+1,N+1))
    pyplot.imshow(numpy.log10(rho.value_in(units.RSun**3)))
    pyplot.show()
```

When generating initial conditions for a grid-based hydrodynamics code, we would ideally like to be able to run the same initial conditions using an SPH code. The translation from a grid to a particle representation is not unique, but the routine `convert_grid_to_SPH` performs such a conversion. The resulting particle distribution still reflects the structure of the grid—even in an SPH code, the structure of the grid is not erased until the system has evolved for a time comparable to the freefall time scale (Section 6.1.3.1).

6.3 Extending the Hydrodynamics Solver

Many hydrodynamical studies focus on the evolution of a fluid flow with specified initial conditions, as discussed in Section 6.5 and Section 6.4.2 below. In some cases, however, we need to understand what happens when gas enters or leaves the system. In this section, we explore how such processes are implemented in AMUSE.

6.3.1 Generating New SPH Particles

New gas may be introduced as part of the boundary conditions in the computational domain (such as the inflow of a gas stream from one side), or from a source within the simulated volume (such as a stellar wind or a supernova). In the SPH formalism, new gas is introduced simply by initializing new particles on some surface or in some volume around a source. The location of the source and the state of the gas are typically provided by another code, such as a stellar evolution calculation that generates a wind from an evolving star.

The code fragment below demonstrates how to create `n_new` new SPH particles in an existing system, add them to the existing gas particles (`gas_particles`), and subsequently synchronize the gas particles in the main Python script with the particles in the `hydro` code.

```
new_gas = Particles(n_new)
give_particles_some_properties(new_gas)
gas_particles.add_particles(new_gas)
gas_particles.synchronize_to(hydro.gas_particles)
```

The astronomical magic is hidden in the routine `give_particles_some_properties()`, which provides the newly created particles with position, velocity, temperature, etc. We do not spell out this function in detail, but an example is provided in Code example 6.2. The function `synchronize_to` ensures that the particle set in the main script is consistent with the particles in the `hydro` module. Note that we could have accomplished the same result by adding `new_gas` directly to the `hydro` particle set:

```
hydro.gas_particles.add_particles(new_gas)
```

Code example 6.2 presents an example of how to set the characteristics of the SPH particles. In this case, we are modeling the colliding winds of a binary star system. The positions and velocities of these stars typically come from a gravity code, while the stellar parameters are determined by a stellar evolution code. The amount of mass lost by each star is included in the star particles as a free parameter (`star.MWind`), which can be set in the main script from the stellar evolution code. The attribute `MWind` is not standard, but is temporarily added to the stellar particle set just for this purpose.

The new particles created in Code example 6.2 can be incorporated into the SPH code in two basic ways. At one extreme, they could be given high radial velocities but low temperatures, in which case the SPH code will establish a wind-like outflow that will shock and thermalize as it impacts the surrounding medium. Alternatively, at the other extreme, they could be given low velocities and high temperatures, consistent with the post-shock thermalized gas, as calculated by the routine in Code example 6.3. The wind speed and/or shocked temperatures can be taken from a stellar evolution code. In reality, the proper prescription lies somewhere in between.

We must make these choices because SPH is incapable of resolving the small-scale details of the true outflow, as the wind streams out, shocks, and thermalizes, so we must inject the energy as some combination of kinetic and thermal energy. The details can be resolved by some AMR grid models, but at the cost of very short time steps. The

```

24 def new_sph_particles_from_stellar_wind(stars, mass_per_gas_particle):
25     new_sph = Particles(0)
26     for i, star in enumerate(stars):
27         number_of_gas = int(-star.Mwind / mass_per_gas_particle)
28         if number_of_gas == 0:
29             continue
30         total_mass_of_gas = mass_per_gas_particle * number_of_gas
31         star.Mwind += total_mass_of_gas
32         new_gas = Particles(number_of_gas)
33         new_gas.mass = mass_per_gas_particle
34         new_gas.h_smooth = 0.0 | units.parsec
35
36         dx, dy, dz = uniform_unit_sphere(number_of_gas).make_xyz()
37         new_gas.x = star.x + (dx * star.radius)
38         new_gas.y = star.y + (dy * star.radius)
39         new_gas.z = star.z + (dz * star.radius)
40         for j, gas_particle in enumerate(new_gas):
41             r = gas_particle.position - star.position
42             r = r / r.length()
43             v_wind = (
44                 constants.G
45                 * star.mass
46                 / (gas_particle.position - star.position).length()
47             ).sqrt()
48             gas_particle.u = 0.5 * (v_wind) ** 2
49             gas_particle.vx = star.vx + r[0] * star.terminal_wind_velocity
50             gas_particle.vy = star.vy + r[1] * star.terminal_wind_velocity
51             gas_particle.vz = star.vz + r[2] * star.terminal_wind_velocity
52         new_sph.add_particles(new_gas)
53     return new_sph

```

Code example 6.2: Routine to generate new SPH particles modeling the stellar wind of a set of stars. This code example is a fragment from the script `amuse.examples.hydro_outflow_particles`. The full script models a colliding-wind binary system and will take several weeks to run on a laptop. In Chapter 9, we present an example of how this code works when coupled to gravity.

```

60 def v_terminal_teff(star):
61     t4 = (np.log10(star.temperature.value_in(units.K)) - 4.0).clip(0.0, 1.0)
62     return (30 | units.km / units.s) + ((4000 | units.km / units.s) * t4)

```

Code example 6.3: Determining the terminal velocity of an SPH particle for a star with a given temperature. This expression was used by [Pelupessy & Portegies Zwart \(2012\)](#) to determine the terminal velocity of the winds of massive stars.

best choice between pure kinetic and pure thermal energy input is generally resolution-dependent. It is interesting to try both extreme methods to see the effect of these different strategies on the results of the simulation. In Section 6.4.3, we discuss an example in which a star accretes from a companion wind.

6.3.2 Removing SPH Particles

It is sometimes also necessary to remove gas from a system, for example when it leaves the computational domain, falls into a black hole, or is accreted by another object. Removing gas is not much harder than adding gas, as discussed in Section 6.3.1. We simply

delete the unwanted gas particles from the local particle set, via `particles_to_remove`, and synchronize the particle set in the hydro code.

```
removed_particles = particles_to_remove.copy()
gas_particles.remove_particles(particles_to_remove)
gas_particles.synchronize_to(hydro.gas_particles)
```

We store a copy of the removed particles in a local particle set called `removed_particles`. Later, we might use this particle set to check that we properly removed all particles, and that conserved quantities, such as mass, are actually conserved.

In many applications, particles are removed when they are accreted by a sink particle, which swallows gas particles when they approach within some specified distance. A sink particle has mass, position, radius, velocity, and possibly more parameters, such as some notion of the number of gas particles accreted, the accreted angular momentum, or the chemical composition of the accreted material. A sink particle can be declared just like any other particle (refer to Section 4.3.1 for an example). Here is a simple example of a non-moving sink particle with zero mass at the origin of the coordinate system:

```
sink = Particle()
sink.mass = 0 | units.MSun
sink.radius = 1 | units.au
sink.position = (0, 0, 0) | units.au
sink.velocity = (0, 0, 0) | units.kms
sink.accreted_mass = 0 | units.MSun
```

The radius of the sink particle is arbitrarily set here to `1 | units.au`, but in practice this radius reflects the distance from which it accretes.

Code example 6.4 presents a simple example of how we might decide which particles should be accreted by a collection of sink particles and removed from the calculation. Although simple, it shows the fundamental way in which gas accretion can be managed. This method is used, for example, in molecular-cloud collapse simulations, when sinks are formed in a Jeans unstable clump. The equations of motion of the sink can be integrated using an N -body code, while at the same time it can continue to accrete from the surrounding gas. The techniques needed to couple the gravity solver with a hydro code are discussed in Chapters 8 and 9. In Section 6.4.3, we present a simple example of a small experiment with a sink particle; a more elaborate example is discussed in Chapter 10.

Stars (or other objects) may emit and accrete gas particles at the same time. For example, a protostar might accrete matter from the inner edge of a surrounding disk while simultaneously emitting jets perpendicular to the disk. A simple way to realize this is to place the sink over the center of mass of the star, with an accretion radius smaller than the radius at which wind particles are released.

6.3.3 Sinks and Dark Matter Particles

In the previous section, we discussed the possibility of allowing sinks to form and to accrete material. Once a sink forms, it behaves like a point particle that interacts

```

1 from amuse.units import units, nbody_system
2 from amuse.ic.gasplummer import new_plummer_gas_model
3
4
5 def accrete_particles(sinks, gas):
6     removed_particles = Particles()
7     for s in sinks:
8         xs, ys, zs = s.x, s.y, s.z
9         radius_squared = s.radius**2
10        insink = gas.select_array(
11            lambda x, y, z: (x - xs) ** 2 + (y - ys) ** 2 + (z - zs) ** 2
12            < radius_squared,
13            ["x", "y", "z"],
14        )
15        if len(insink) == 0:
16            return insink

```

Code example 6.4: A sink particle consumes gas particles. This is a fragment from the script `amuse.examples.hydro_sink_particles`.

gravitationally but not hydrodynamically with the rest of the system, unlike a parcel of gas. Sinks are widely used in hydrodynamics codes as a way to avoid the need to follow star formation to small and very costly scales once a pocket of gas becomes Jeans unstable and starts to collapse. Combining the collapsing mass into a sink that continues to accrete but no longer behaves as a fluid particle realizes substantial savings in computer time. In many ways, sink particles in the AMUSE `hydro` modules are the fluid analogs of the binary and multiple systems managed by the `multiples` module (see Section 8.7.2)—except that interactions among sinks are far easier to handle, as we will see (Section 6.3.4).

Most hydrodynamics solvers can accommodate sinks because they are designed to include non-gas particles in the calculation. Some codes use built-in “sink particles” to follow the formation and accretion of protostars. Others include “dark matter particles” intended to model dark matter in galactic or cosmological contexts, but they too can be used to model sinks. When they exist in an SPH code, AMUSE refers to them as `dm_particles` to distinguish them from the `gas_particles` we have already encountered. Dark matter particles can be quite handy and are used in a wide variety of applications, including compact objects or as the degenerate core of a star on the giant branch. In the latter case, the giant’s envelope would be comprised of gas particles. The more generic particle set `particles` is also available, and contains both the `gas` and the `dm` particles.

On adding a new particle to an SPH code, it is important to indicate whether it is a `gas` or a `dm` particle. The former is evolved according to the fluid equations of motion, possibly including self-gravity; the latter is affected only by gravity. Used as sinks, dark matter particles can continue to accrete from the surrounding gas, under the control of the top-level AMUSE script.

Dark matter particles in a hydro code are integrated according to Newton’s equations of motion. In most codes, the integration itself is realized using a second-order Leapfrog scheme, and the gravitational potential is softened (see Section 4.1.4). This

is probably sufficient for many hydrodynamical problems in which one is not interested in the subtleties of the gravitational dynamics. However, in Chapter 4, we discussed far more accurate gravity solvers, and it may be desirable to integrate the dark matter particles using one of those methods. This requires code coupling, which we discuss in Chapter 9.

6.3.4 Cooling the Gas Using an External Routine

Heating and cooling are computed and applied by the `evolve_model()` member function in the cooling class, which adjusts the internal energy and temperature of the gas according to a simple physical model, forcing the gas toward an isothermal equation of state on a time scale consistent with actual cooling processes (see Section 6.3.4). It was used by Lützgendorf *et al.* (2016) (see also Section 10.4) to cool the hot winds of the S-stars orbiting the supermassive black hole in the Galactic center. The results are applied directly to particles or grid cells (Gerritsen & Icke, 1997); the hydro code then takes care of the consequences.

The calling sequence between `hydro_model` and `cooling_model` is

```
cooling = cooling_model()
hydro = hydro_model()
dt = 0.05 | units.Myr
while time < t_end:
    time += dt/2
    channel_to_cooling.copy()
    cooling.evolve_model(time)
    channel_from_cooling_to_hydro.copy()
    time += dt/2
    hydro.evolve_model(time)
    channel_from_hydro_to_cooling.copy()
    cooling.evolve_model(time)
    channel_to_framework.copy()
```

Note that we advance the cooling for half a step, then use that temperature structure to advance the hydro for a full step, then complete the cooling step. This interlaced stepping strategy results in second-order coupling between the cooling and hydro codes. It is inspired by the second-order code coupling strategy discussed in Chapter 9. The same time-stepping strategy was adopted when combining stellar evolution and gravitational dynamics in Chapter 8. The choice of time step `dt` is a matter of experimentation and some art. Overly large time steps will lead to errors, but small time steps can make the code very slow. The proper time step is determined using convergence arguments (see Section 6.6 for a discussion).

6.3.5 Stopping conditions

Much in the same way as the gravity codes (Section 4.5.1 and the stellar evolution modules (Section 5.2.10), also hydrodynamics solvers have their own stopping conditions.

Table 6.3: Overview of the stopping conditions available in most N -body codes.

stopping_conditions_	default value	default unit
...maximum_density	max	mass/(length**3)
...minimum_density	-1.0	mass / (length**3)
...maximum_internal_energy	max	length**2 / (time**2)
...minimum_internal_energy	-1.0	length**2 / (time**2)
...number_of_steps	1	none
...out_of_box_size	0.0	length
...out_of_box_use_center_of_mass	1	none
...timeout	4.0	s
...pair_detection	4.0	s

The most common stopping conditions for hydro are listed in Table 6.3. These include detections for the upper or lower limits on local density, binary hardness, and for particles leaving the computational domain, but also limits on the number of steps, and computational time-out.

6.4 Some simple experiments

6.4.1 Circumstellar Disk with a Bump

Planets form in disks, but these disks tend to be lumpy. In this example, we show that a lump disperses in a few orbits. We start our simulations with an axisymmetric $1 M_{\odot}$ disk, with an isothermal equation of state, around a $10 M_{\odot}$ star. The density falls off toward the outer edge of the disk as a power law with exponent $-3/2$. The inner and outer edges are at 10 au and 100 au. These choices are largely motivated by the numerical cost of extending the disk closer to the central star. After generating the disk, we introduce a small perturbation in the form of a bump in a circular orbit at a distance of 50 au from the star. The bump was generated using a Plummer gas sphere with a characteristic radius of 5 au and a mass of $0.5 M_{\odot}$. Code example 6.5 presents a snapshot of the routine used to generate the disk and bump.

```

159 def new_disk_with_bump(
160     mass_star=10 | units.MSun,
161     n_disk=100,
162     mass_disk=1.0 | units.MSun,
163     radius_min=1.0 | units.au,
164     radius_max=100.0 | units.au,
165     mass_bump=0.1 | units.MSun,
166     radius_bump=5.0 | units.au,
167     dist_bump=10 | units.au,
168 ):
169
170     converter = nbody_system.nbody_to_si(mass_star, radius_min)
171     disk = ProtoPlanetaryDisk(
172         n_disk,
173         convert_nbody=converter,
174         densitypower=1.5,
175         Rmin=1,
176         Rmax=radius_max / radius_min,
177         q_out=1.0,
178         discfraction=mass_disk / mass_star,
179     ).result
180     com = disk.center_of_mass()
181
182     # determine bump's local velocity
183
184     inner_particles = disk.select(
185         lambda r: (com - r).length() < dist_bump, ["position"]
186     )
187     M_inner = mass_star + inner_particles.mass.sum()
188     v_circ = (
189         (constants.G * M_inner * (2.0 / dist_bump - 1.0 / dist_bump)).sqrt().
190         value_in(units.kms)
191     )
192
193     # initialize bump
194
195     Nbump = int(n_disk * mass_bump / mass_disk)
196     bump = new_plummer_gas_model(
197         Nbump, convert_nbody=nbody_system.nbody_to_si(mass_bump, radius_bump)
198     )
199     bump.x += dist_bump
200     bump.velocity += [0, v_circ, 0] | units.kms
201
202     disk.add_particles(bump)
203     disk.move_to_center()
204     return disk

```

Code example 6.5: Routine to generate a disk with a Plummer model bump. This code example is a fragment from the script `amuse.examples.hydro_disk_with_bump`.

The disk is constructed from a cylindrical slice in which all particles are in circular Keplerian orbits around the central star, with a radial density profile described by a power law and a scale height consistent with the adopted Safronov–Toomre Q -parameter (see below; [Safronov, 1960](#); [Toomre, 1964](#)). This is realized using the routine

```

disk = ProtoPlanetaryDisk(
    n_disk,
    convert_nbody=converter,
    densitypower=1.5,
    Rmin=1,
    Rmax=Rmax/Rmin,
    q_out=1.0,
    discfraction=1.0,
).result

```

which takes as arguments the number of disk particles, a converter, a density power law (here 1.5, lower density at the outer rim), the minimum and maximum disk radii, the Safronov–Toomre Q -parameter, and the mass fraction of the disk. The scaling parameters in this argument list (**Rmin**, **Rmax**, and **discfraction**) are relative to the converter parameters (in this example, 1 $M_{\odot}$ and 10 au).¹

The Safronov–Toomre parameter provides a stability criterion for a differentially rotating disk. It can be derived from the Jeans stability criterion by comparing the self-gravity of the disk with its thermal pressure, and can be expressed in terms of the radial velocity dispersion σ_r (or the sound speed for gaseous disks), the epicyclic frequency κ , and the surface density Σ :

$$Q = \frac{\sigma_r \kappa}{\pi G \Sigma}. \quad (6.30)$$

Disks tend to be stable for $Q > 1$. In Code example 6.5, we generate the disk with $Q = 1$, which results in a barely stable, rather flat disk. (Later, in Section 8.6.1, we will present an example of a much more stable thick disk with $Q = 25$.)

The disk is generated using 50,000 SPH particles, with 25,000 more for the bump, and a softening length of $\varepsilon = 10$ au. We then select an SPH code for the hydrodynamics, in this case **Gadget2**. To keep things simple, we include the central star as a dark matter particle in the hydro code. We subsequently integrate the equations of motion of the star and the hydrodynamics of the gas for 2000 yr, which is long compared to the ~ 100 yr Keplerian orbital period of the bump around the star. Figure 6.5 presents snapshots of the disk plus bump 2000 yr after the start of the simulation. By this time, the bump has been spread out over the disk, forming a nice spiral arm. We will study the survival time of the bump in Assignment 6.7.3

6.4.2 Colliding Stars

Collisions play an important role in the evolution of the stars in dense star clusters (Hills & Day, 1976), as well as for the formation of the Moon and other solar system objects (Benz *et al.*, 1986). In a pioneering study, Benz & Hills (1987) performed SPH simulations of the collisions of stars in a star cluster environment. Their simulations followed collisions of identical low-mass main sequence stars, modeled as simple $n = 3/2$ polytropes (Chandrasekhar, 1933), on both head-on and grazing trajectories. Their

¹Instead of generating a standard protoplanetary disk, we could have achieved a similar initial condition using the more general routine to construct a uniform cylinder using **uniform_unit_cylinder**.

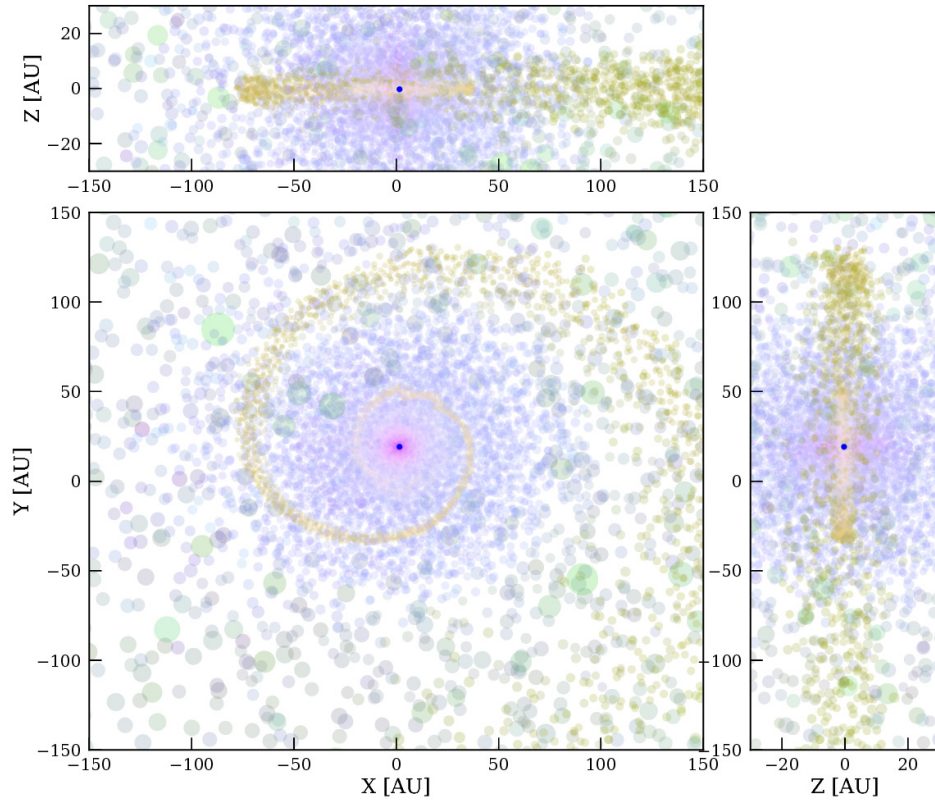


Figure 6.5: Face-on and edge-on views of the disk with a bump after 2000 yr. Individual SPH particles (75000 in total) are represented as semi-transparent bullet points. The sizes represent their height above the disk, relative to the z scale height, and the colors are generated from the pressure, velocity and temperature represented by red, green and blue, respectively. The lack of blue in the spiral arm, which is a result of the disrupted bump, is a result of the relatively low temperature of the bump with respect to the rest of the disk. The calculation was performed using the script `amuse.examples.hydro_disk_with_bump`, the figure was made with `amuse.examples.plot_hydro_disk_with_bump`.

main conclusion was that grazing collisions result in higher degrees of mixing of the inner and outer stellar layers than do head-on collisions.

Instead of two polytropes, we adopt here a full Henyey stellar evolution model of two $0.6 M_{\odot}$ stars evolved to 12 Gyr using MESA (see Section 6.2). The two evolved stellar models were converted to SPH particle representations using the routine presented in Code example 8.11 and described in Section 8.5.4. Our SPH realization has a mass resolution of $20 M_{\text{Earth}}$ per SPH particle (significantly finer resolution than the original calculations). Our head-on collision has zero velocity at infinity, so the relative speed of the two stars is $v = v_{\text{esc}} = \sqrt{2Gm/r} \simeq 440 \text{ km s}^{-1}$. Here, $m = m_1 + m_2$ is the total mass and r is the initial separation. Following Benz & Hills (1987), we start the two stars touching, so $r = r_1 + r_2$. The grazing collision has initial relative speed $v = 1.67 v_{\text{esc}} \simeq 740 \text{ km s}^{-1}$. Because Benz and Hills neglected to mention the adopted impact parameter, we simply placed the stars in contact with a transverse offset of $0.5(r_1 + r_2)$ (see their Table 1).

The results are summarized in Figure 10 of Benz & Hills (1987). Figure 6.6 presents a similar figure showing the results of our simulations. The leftmost four bars indicate the initial structure of the stars. The second set of bars indicates the degree of mixing

in the merger product following the head-on collision. The rightmost set shows the result of a grazing collision. Comparing our Figure 6.6 with Figure 10 of Benz & Hills (1987), we observe differences in the degree of mixing. The head-on case compares reasonably well with the original calculation. The innermost quartile of the merger product is refreshed with about 15% of material from the next quartile out, whereas the outermost region (fourth quartile) is enriched with roughly 20% of material from below (third quartile). Overall, the degree of mixing in this case is less than reported by Benz and Hills. In contrast, the grazing collision seems to mix the stars more effectively in our simulation than in the original calculations. Virtually all of the mass in the first quartile of the incoming stars is lifted to higher zones, more than 50% of it finding its way into the outermost two quartiles of the merger product.

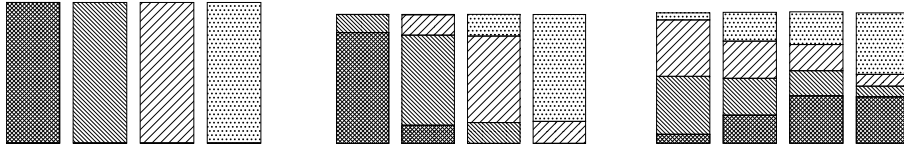


Figure 6.6: Recomputation of Figure 10 in Benz & Hills (1987), in which two 12 Gyr old $0.6 M_{\odot}$ main-sequence collide with zero velocity at infinity. The left set of four vertical bars depicts the initial (pre-collision) structure of the stars; the various shading schemes represent the inner 25%, 50%, 75%, and the outer 25% of the mass. The middle set shows how the original stellar material is rearranged following a head-on collision, while the right-hand set shows the result of a grazing collision. The figure was made using the script `amuse.examples.plot_1987ApJ...323..614B` which depends on two other modules `star_to_sph` and `1987ApJ...323..614B` in the `amuse.examples` package. Running the hydrodynamics of the collision takes a few hours on a laptop.

6.4.3 Accreting from the Wind of a Companion

In this example, we measure the amount of mass accreted by a $1 M_{\odot}$ star from the wind of a $2 M_{\odot}$ companion. Both stars have reached an age of 1.494 Gyr, at which time the $2 M_{\odot}$ primary has lost some $0.0752 M_{\odot}$ of its initial mass and has grown into a supergiant of radius 0.99 au and surface temperature 3300 K. Its wind speed is $v_w \sim 30 \text{ km s}^{-1}$, with a mass-loss rate of $\dot{m} \approx 0.11 M_{\odot} \text{ Myr}^{-1}$. The $1 M_{\odot}$ companion star has not lost much mass yet and is still on the main sequence. Its radius is $0.0043 \text{ au} = 0.93 R_{\odot}$.

We place the stars on a circular orbit at a separation of 10 au, and start the hydrodynamics solver. We adopt an SPH particle mass of $3 \times 10^{-11} M_{\odot}$ and integrate the hydrodynamics with a time step of one day, after which we launch new SPH particles using the simple wind module discussed in Section 6.3.1. Gas particles accreted by the $1 M_{\odot}$ star, more than 200 au from the primary, are removed according to the method described in Section 6.3.2. Accretion is modeled by placing a sink particle (see Section 6.3.4) at the location of—and moving on the same orbit as—the $1 M_{\odot}$ star. We include gravity by following the stars as dark matter particles in the hydro code.

Synchronization between wind particles and accreted particles is accomplished by

```

accreted = sink.accrete(interstellar_gas_particles)
interstellar_gas_particles.remove_particles(accreted)
interstellar_gas_particles.synchronize_to(hydro_gas_particles)

```

Here `stellar_particles` and `sink_radius` are, respectively, the stellar particles added to the sink and the radius of the sink.

Figure 6.7 presents the accretion rate onto the $1 M_{\odot}$ star as a function of time. The red curve is calculated using a sink particle that did not move and had a radius equal to the star’s Bondi–Hoyle–Lyttleton (Bondi & Hoyle, 1944; Hoyle & Lyttleton, 1939) radius of ~ 2 au.² The blue curve is for a normal-sized star with self-gravity included. As can be seen, both approaches give the same results, within the statistical uncertainty, with a mean accretion rate of $\sim 0.0022 M_{\odot} \text{ Myr}^{-1}$. One might possibly argue that the Bondi–Hoyle–Lyttleton accretion starts a little earlier. This can be understood from the fact that particles have to travel less distance before being swallowed by the accreting star, simply because its accreting surface is closer to the companion.

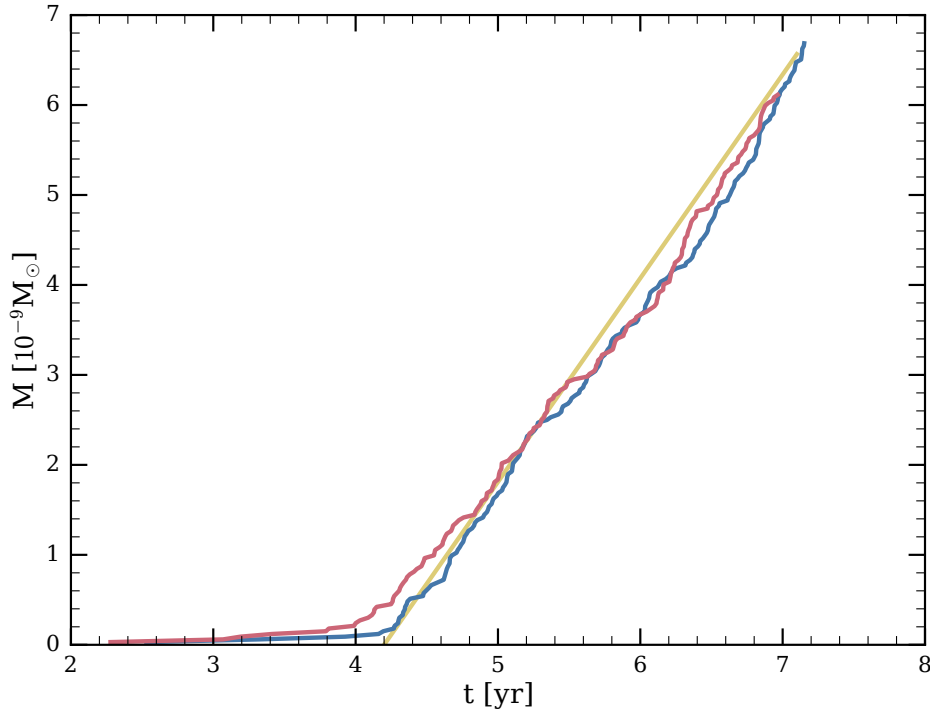


Figure 6.7: Accretion rate onto a $1 M_{\odot}$ star embedded in the dense wind of a $2 M_{\odot}$ companion on the asymptotic giant branch. The blue curve is calculated using the formal accretion radius from the stellar evolution code and the gravity solver in the hydrodynamics code. The red curve is calculated using the Bondi–Hoyle–Lyttleton accretion radius of the star (~ 2 AU), without taking the primary’s self-gravity into account. The yellow curve gives an estimate of the accretion rate using Equation (6.31) and adopting a wind velocity of 17.3 km/s . The hydrodynamics was resolved using `amuse.examples.hydro_give_or_take`. The plot was made with `amuse.examples.plot_accretion_from_windy_star`.

The accretion rate from a steady wind can be approximated as (Theuns *et al.*, 1996)

$$\dot{M} \propto \mu^2 k^4 (1 + k^2)^{-3/2} \dot{M}_{\text{donor}}. \quad (6.31)$$

²The Bondi–Hoyle–Lyttleton radius R_{BHL} is the effective accretion radius of a gravitating body. For an object of mass M and incoming material moving at speed v , $R_{\text{BHL}} \simeq 2GM/v^2$.

Here, $\mu \equiv m_2/(m_1 + m_2)$ and $k \equiv v_{\text{orb}}/v_{\text{wind}}$. The mass ratio hardly changes during the integration and $\mu \simeq 0.34$, but the velocity in the wind at the location of the companion star is considerably lower than the terminal wind velocity used as input for generating the wind. The wind velocity measurement in the simulation that included self-gravity resulted in $\langle v_{\text{wind}} \rangle \simeq 17.3 \text{ km s}^{-1}$. With this wind velocity, the accretion rate calculated with Equation (6.31) is consistent with the simulations (the yellow line in Figure 6.7).

6.4.4 Continuing with Hydrodynamics after a Henyey Code Crash

In Section 6.2.5 we compared grid and SPH hydro simulations of a simplified exploding star. The initial conditions for these simulations were quite far from reality, if one is really interested in supernova explosions. Specifically, the density, temperature, and momentum structure of the two-component model in Section 6.2.5 could easily be improved if we adopted a Henyey stellar evolution code to generate the stellar structure at the moment of the explosion.

For our more realistic star, we will use the stellar structure from Section 8.3.3 and continue from the point when the stellar evolution model failed to converge, leading to a crash. As noted earlier, the termination of the stellar evolution code does not crash the AMUSE script, so we can pick up the last converged stellar model as input to a hydrodynamical model of the supernova explosion that crashed the Henyey code. For definiteness, we continue the calculation using an SPH code. (It would have been equally easy to adopt a grid-based code.)

We first convert the stellar model to an SPH particle realization, much as in Section 6.4.2. We then inject energy into the innermost SPH particles to start the explosion. Code example 6.6 shows how we inject 10^{51} erg into the core of the SPH realization of the Henyey stellar model (see also Section 6.2.5). Note that selecting the right number of SPH particles is rather tricky and can easily lead to artificial numerical effects in the simulations. If too few are selected, individual SPH particles may penetrate the stellar envelope and leave the star without transferring their energy. On the other hand, if the supernova energy is divided among too many SPH particles, it may not be sufficient to drive the supernova explosion. Ideally, the energy should be divided among the particles corresponding to the degenerate core of the stellar model, and this may be achieved with a sufficiently high resolution in the hydrodynamical simulation. After the energy is injected, we start the hydro code, feed it the SPH particle set, and let it run. The resulting evolution of the thermal, kinetic, and potential energies is presented in Figure 6.8.

```

1 out_pickle_file = os.path.join(
2     get_path_to_results(), "super_giant_stellar_structure.pkl"
3 )
4 if os.path.exists(out_pickle_file):
5     return out_pickle_file

```

Code example 6.6: Routine to inject 10^{51} erg into the innermost regions of an SPH realization of an exploding star.

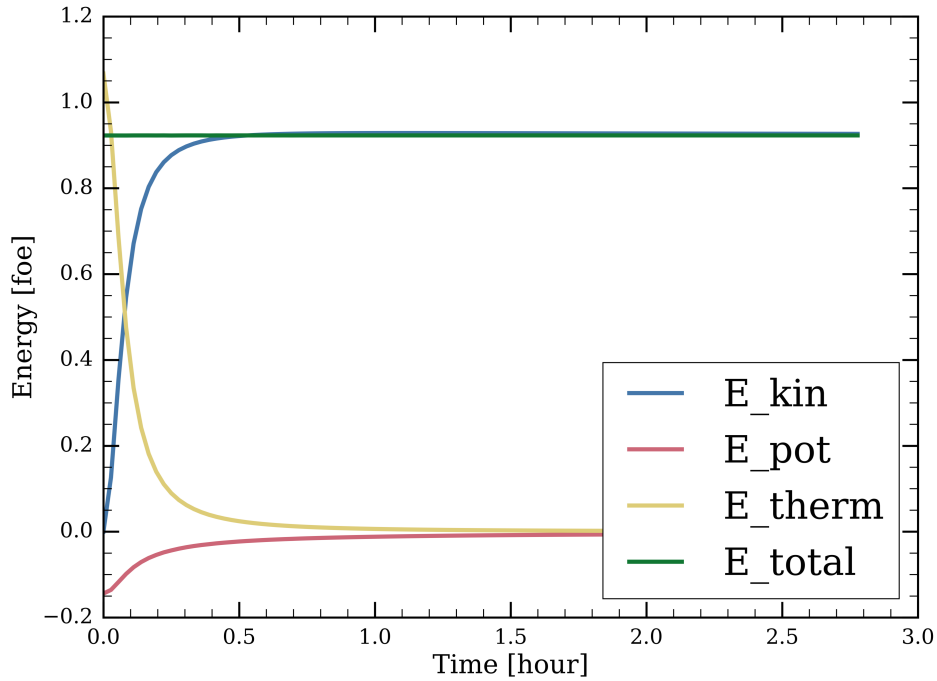


Figure 6.8: Evolution of the energy of an exploding $10 M_{\odot}$ star. The star was first evolved using MESA to the tip of the asymptotic giant branch. After this the 1-dimensional Henyey model was converted to a particle (SPH) representation. At that point we injected 10^{51} erg into the stellar core and continued the hydrodynamical evolution using `Gadget2`. The figure was produced with `amuse.examples.explode_evolved_star`, which should run in about 10 minutes on a laptop.

The function `get_path_to_results` referenced in Code example 6.6 is imported from `amuse.test.amusetest`, to provide a standard directory in which temporary files can be stored.

6.5 Collapsing Molecular Cloud

In this section, we present a simple experiment related to hydrodynamics, and in particular on the collapse of a giant molecular cloud. Such simulations are one of the most exciting multi-scale and multi-physics applications of AMUSE, and we continue this discussion with a broader range of codes in Section 10.5.1 by including sink particles and radiative feedback, which results in nice images. We are far from understanding the general collapse of molecular clouds, and much research is expected to be done in improving our knowledge.

Figure 6.9 presents the results of a simple experiment that can be used for pedagogical purposes or to study how a model molecular cloud collapses. Similar simulations have been performed by many authors, but new simulations, even at relatively low resolution, often give interesting results if novel initial conditions are tried. One might, for example, start with a more complex cloud structure, perhaps based on an observed density distribution for which velocity, temperature, and/or composition information is available.

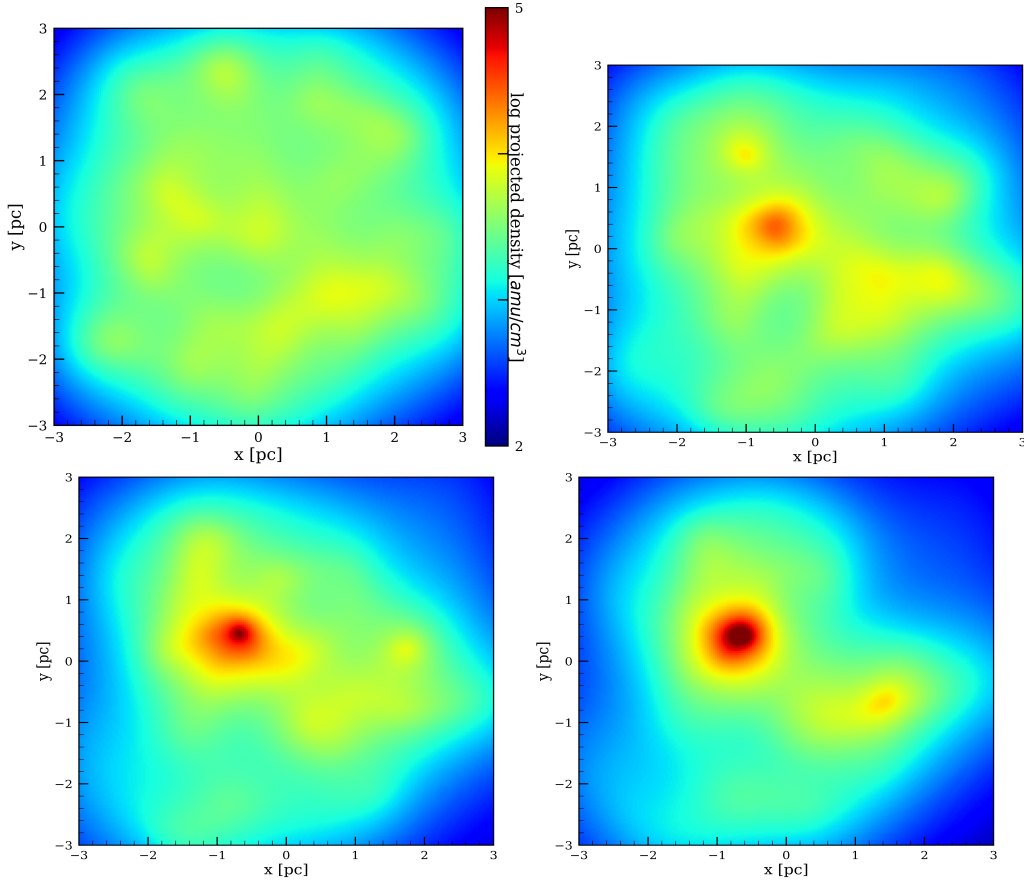


Figure 6.9: Collapse of a homogeneous $10^4 M_\odot$ gas cloud with an initial radius of 3 pc and a turbulent (power-law) velocity field. With these parameters, the free-fall time is $t_{\text{ff}} \approx 0.86$ Myr, and the central density is $6.0 \times 10^{-18} \text{ kg/m}^3$. The hydrodynamical evolution was carried out using the SPH code F1 using just 1000 SPH particles. The four panels show $x - y$ projections of the cloud at 0.25 Myr, 0.50, 0.75, and 1.0 Myr. The same color scheme is used for each panel ($\log_{10}$ projected density). The simulation was performed using the script `amuse.examples.molecular_cloud_collapse`.

6.5.0.1 Initial Conditions

As a starting point, we adopt a homogeneous gas sphere with a power-law velocity power spectrum [$P(k) \propto k^{-4}$, where k is wavenumber] to mimic large-scale turbulence (Bate *et al.*, 2003). This is a popular initial model for simulations of star-forming molecular clouds. At the start of the simulation, we scale the internal energy such that the cloud begins to collapse, resulting in a cloud with a mean temperature of about 23 K. We recognize that these initial conditions are not very realistic, but they are convenient and widely used in the community. The resolution of our simulation is low (only 1000 particles, i.e. $10 M_\odot$ per SPH particle), and the softening is large (~ 0.1 pc). We can see the cloud form interesting substructure as it evolves. The substructure in the collapsing cloud originates entirely from the initial velocity field, and while the initial model is idealized, the clumps and filaments that form are thought to be key ingredients in the collapse of real star-forming regions.

In the next few subsections, we extend this simple calculation in two key ways:

adding a more realistic description of the equation of state of the gas, and allowing the possibility of star formation as the collapse proceeds. Both are implemented at the framework (Python) level.

1. Earlier we encountered an adiabatic equation of state, which is basically a cheap way of approximating the result of the interplay between heating and cooling processes. More complex hydrodynamical problems generally require some form of explicit heating and cooling. Not all hydro codes have explicit treatments of heating or cooling, but even if they don't, we can still heat and cool the gas via AMUSE. In Section 6.3.4, we describe how to introduce explicit cooling into the hydrodynamics solver to simulate the collapse of an isothermal molecular cloud.
2. When individual parcels of gas become sufficiently dense to collapse, we turn them into sinks (see Section 6.3.3). These sinks can be integrated using the internal hydrodynamics N -body integrator (usually a Leapfrog or Verlet code; see Section 4.2.2). They can continue to accrete, or can merge if two sinks approach sufficiently closely. The details are described in Section 6.5.1. In Chapter 9, we will demonstrate how a high-order direct N -body code can be incorporated to integrate the equations of motion of the sink particles more accurately.

In these cases, we will find generally it desirable to significantly increase the resolution of our calculations. We now consider these enhancements in turn.

A script that performs the entire simulation with cooling and sinks can be found in `amuse.examples.molecular_cloud_collapse_with_sinks`. Since this code is a bit more complicated than anything we have encountered so far, we have split some of the ingredients into Python classes. New to this script is a hydrodynamics class `hydro_model`, defined in `hydrodynamics_class`, and a rudimentary cooling class `cooling_model`, in `cooling_class`.

6.5.1 Star Formation in a Collapsing Molecular Cloud

Star formation is implemented by creating sink particles in regions of gas that exceed a specified critical density `density_threshold` (see Section 6.3.2). The stopping condition for detecting high-density particles or cells is set by

```
code.parameters.stopping_condition_maximum_density = density_threshold
density_limit_detection = self.code.stopping_conditions.density_limit_detection
density_limit_detection.enable()
```

The exception is raised when any high-density gas is detected. Loosely, “high-density” generally means something substantially above the average, although there is a more formal prescription based on the resolution of the simulation, related to smoothing length, internal energy, and particle mass (Federrath *et al.*, 2010; Bleuler & Teyssier, 2014; Sormani *et al.*, 2017).

In Section 6.3.2, we used a simple particle as a sink, but we could do better by importing the AMUSE sink particle module. This internal module is not much different from a simple particle set, except that it takes care of some rudimentary aspects of

conservation following accretion. It is accessed by

```
from amuse.ext.sink import new_sink_particles
```

Sink particles can be initialized from a host particle set `host_particles`:

```
sink_particles = new_sink_particles(host_particles, sink_radius)
```

The `host_particles` set can be stars in a gravity code or dark matter particles in an SPH code. The parameter `sink_radius` here is the radius of the sink particle, which is used to determine when ambient gas is accreted and when sinks merge.

New sinks can be created after a hydrodynamics code stopping condition is reached, or (as here) by searching for high-density regions in the gas distribution. In either case, the Python script must search for high-density particles (or cells), then create new sinks and add them to the hydro code:

```
highdens = gas_particles.select_array(lambda rho:rho>density_threshold, ["rho"])
candidate_sinks = highdens.copy()
gas_particles.remove_particles(highdens)
newsinks_in_code = hydro.dm_particles.add_particles(candidate_sinks)
newsinks = Particles()
for nsi in newsinks_in_code:
    if nsi not in self.sink_particles:
        newsinks.add_particle(nsi)
sink_particles.add_sinks(newsinks)
```

Here, the newly found sinks are added to the (previously created) particle set `sink_particles`.

When two sinks approach within `sink_radius` (typically the sum of the individual radii) of one another, they can be merged in much the same way as stellar mergers in the stellar evolution example in Code example 5.5 of Section 5.2.8. As soon as the mass of a sink exceeds some threshold, we could start a stellar evolution code and take stellar evolution into account in setting the mass and size of the growing star (see Chapter 5). However, increasing the stellar mass due to accretion onto the sink requires some more thought, which would take us beyond the scope of this chapter.

6.5.2 Stellar Winds and spherical outflows

To make the problem a little more realistic, we include stellar evolution using the parameterized stellar evolution code `SeBa` and take the winds generated by young stars (particle set `stars`) into account using the internal `amuse.ext` stellar wind module:

```
from amuse.ext.stellar_wind import new_stellar_wind
```

This module generates new SPH particles near the mass-losing stars, with wind parameters (position, velocity, density, temperature) derived from the stellar evolution code, and hands these particles back to the SPH code. The SPH code later automatically takes care of incorporating the effect of the stellar wind into the residual gas.

```

wind = new_stellar_wind(
    mass_gas,
    target_gas=gas,
    timestep=time_step,
    derive_from_evolution=True,
)
wind.particles.add_particles(stars)
channel_to_wind = stars.new_channel_to(wind.particles)

```

Here, `mass_gas` is the mass of an individual gas particle in the stellar wind generated over a time interval `time_step`. Then the `stars`, which are also in the stellar evolution code, are added as particles to the wind module, and we make a channel from the stars to the wind module in order to ensure that changes to the stars due to stellar evolution are properly propagated to the wind module. In the main event loop, the stellar and wind modules are called and the newly generated wind particles are synchronized with the gas particles in the hydro code:

```

stellar.evolve_model(time)
channel_to_wind.copy()
wind.evolve_model(time)
gas_particles.synchronize_to(hydro_code.gas_particles)

```

Note that the routine `synchronize_to` copies particle properties, it does not copy particles from one set to another.

In Section 10.4.1, we demonstrate how the wind module can be used in conjunction with stellar evolution, gravity and hydro codes to simulate the intricate coupling between strong stellar winds and the dynamics of the stars in orbit around the super-massive black hole in the Galactic center.

6.5.3 The Collapse Calculation

After implementing the above changes into the basic script discussed in Section 6.5, we can start to experiment with a more realistic collapsing gas cloud. (In Figure 9.8, we show another method to arrive at interesting initial conditions for the combined distributions of gas and stars.) Initially, the cloud mass was $10^3 M_{\odot}$, distributed in 10^5 equal-mass particles, and the radius was 2 pc, with the same initial turbulent velocity field as before. Figure 6.10 presents a snapshot of the calculation 4.5 Myr after the start of the run. By this time, the age of the oldest star is almost 3.5 Myr, and the most massive star, born 1.5 Myr after the start of the simulation, is about $6.9 M_{\odot}$.

Recently, [Hacar *et al.* \(2017\)](#) have measured the radio intensity of the molecular N_2H^+ emission in the embedded star cluster NGC 1333. This cluster lies at the center of a stellar clump with a diameter of ~ 2 pc. Star formation has been going on there for some 3 Myr. [Hacar *et al.* \(2017\)](#) estimate the total mass in gas in NGC 1333 to be $\sim 580 M_{\odot}$. The protostars are classified as type 0 to III (see [Adams *et al.*, 1987](#); [Lada & Lada, 2003](#)), allowing an approximate age range to be associated with each. The radio intensity of the observed lines is a proxy for surface density of the dense gas, giving us a (limited) view of the changing cluster environment. We can convert between N_2H^+

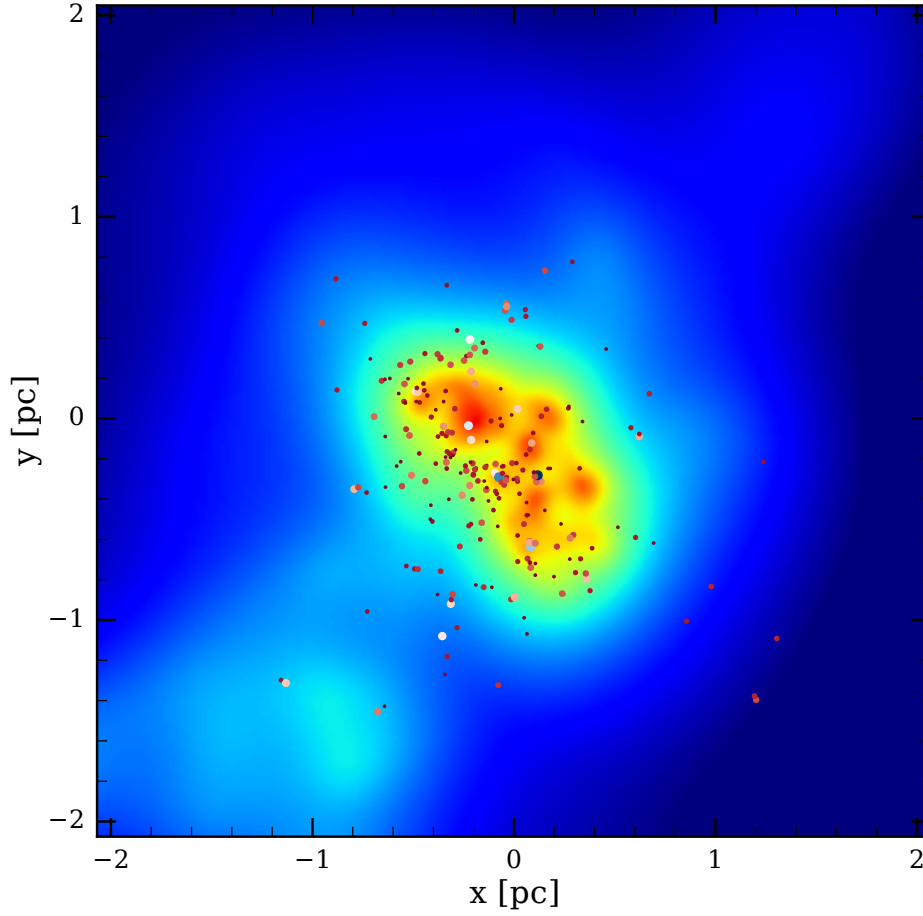


Figure 6.10: Projection of the central portion of a collapsing molecular cloud at an age of 4.5 Myr. The density scale is indicated to the right of the figure in $\log_{10}$ units of amu/cm^3 . The colored bullet points are the stars formed from the densest gas (color coding from dark red for the low mass stars to bright white for the most massive stars). The size of the points is proportional to the logarithm of the mass; the most massive has mass $6.9 M_{\odot}$. The script for this simulation is `amuse.examples.molecular_cloud_collapse_with_sinks`; it uses the two support routines in `amuse.examples.hydrodynamics_class` and `amuse.examples.cooling_class`. This figure was generated using `amuse.examples.plot_molecular_cloud_collapse_with_sinks`.

radio intensity $I_{\text{N}_2\text{H}^+}$ (in units of $\text{K}\cdot\text{km/s}$) and projected molecular hydrogen density N (in cm^{-2}) using the approximate empirical prescription provided by [Hacar *et al.* \(2017\)](#):

$$N \simeq (7.9 I_{\text{N}_2\text{H}^+} + 8.2) \times 10^{21}. \quad (6.32)$$

In computing N for our simulation, we first remove gas with density exceeding $2.64 \times 10^{-21} \text{ g}/\text{cm}^3$, because such gas would be unresolved in the observations. We then convert the projected density of the remaining gas in the model to intensity, in order to compare this with the observations.

Figure 6.11 shows the projected gas density profile in our simulation, relative to the center of mass of the stellar distribution, at an age of 4.5 Myr, and compares it with the inferred projected density distribution in NGC 1333. The various lines indicate the densities in gas and stars. The squares are taken from Figure 3 of [Hacar *et al.* \(2017\)](#). The projected gas density in our simulation is somewhat smaller than the observed

distribution, and our stellar density is somewhat higher. However, apart from the youngest stars, our model density distribution matches the observations reasonably well.

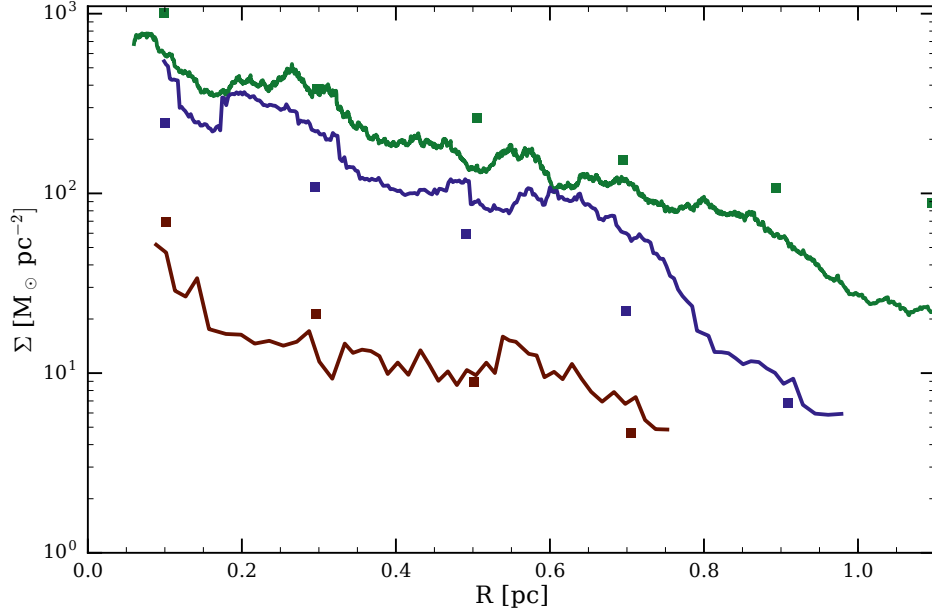


Figure 6.11: Projected density profile (on the x - y plane) of the simulated molecular cloud and stars at an age of 4.5 Myr (lines) and the observed data for NGC 1333 from (Hacar *et al.*, 2017; squares). The top curve (green) and squares represent the density distribution of the gas. The blue curve and squares are projected radial stellar density profiles; the red curve and squares show the density profile only of stars younger than 1.5 Myr (class 0 and class I objects). The observational data are taken directly from Figure 3 of Hacar *et al.* (2017). This figure was made using the simulation presented in Figure 6.10 and the script `amuse.examples.2017AandA...606A.123H_Fig3`.

Hacar *et al.* (2017) further argue that, on average, the younger stars (class 0 and I objects in the observations) are embedded in higher-density gas than the older stars (class II and III). They conclude that older and more massive stars blow bubbles around them, reducing the local gas density (as opposed to the alternative explanation that older stars have simply moved away from the sites where they formed). We test these assertions in Figure 6.12, where we plot the N_2H^+ intensity of gas near young stellar objects in our simulations. The shaded area in Figure 6.12 is constructed from Figure 10 of Hacar *et al.* (2017). It represents the spread in the intensity distribution for each protostellar class. In this figure, we have attributed tentative ages to each observed class of object, from class 0 (~ 0.5 Myr) to class III (2–3 Myr).

The red crosses plotted in Figure 6.12 are from our cloud-collapse simulation, including star formation, stellar evolution (using `SeBa`), and stellar winds. Because the simulation was performed with rather low mass resolution ($0.5 M_\odot$ per particle), we adopted a lower mass ($0.005 M_\odot$) for the wind particles; otherwise, an insufficient amount of wind would be liberated by the stars to generate even a single SPH particle during the simulation. Performing SPH calculations with a mixed mass resolution of the SPH particles can, under some circumstances, result in problems, such as spurious mixing, if not handled carefully. However, when studying systems with small entropy gradients (Lombardi *et al.*, 1999) or large density contrasts, there may be no other op-

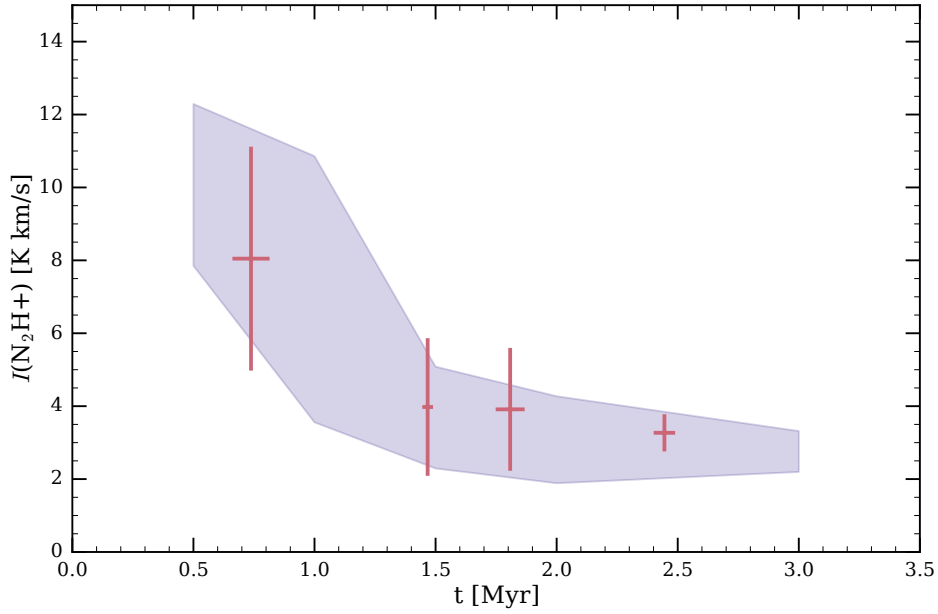


Figure 6.12: Intensity of emission from the molecule N_2H^+ in the direction of the newborn stars in our simulation. The horizontal axis is the age of the star; the vertical axis is (equivalent) intensity of N_2H^+ in units of $\text{K}\cdot\text{km/s}$. The shaded region shows the observed mean intensity of N_2H^+ in NGC 1333 as a function of the ages of the protostars studied by [Hacar et al. \(2017\)](#). The error bars give the 90% confidence intervals for the N_2H^+ intensity of the simulated young stellar objects. We adopt the following age ranges: 0–1 Myr for class 0, 1–1.5 Myr for class I, 1.5–2 Myr for class II, and 2–3 Myr for class III. The figure was made using the simulation presented in Figure 6.10 and the script `amuse.examples.2017AandA...606A.123H_Fig10`.

tion than to run with different particle masses. Some SPH codes are, in fact, designed specifically with these objectives in mind ([Gaburov et al., 2010](#)). In Section 6.7.4, we encourage the reader to try this out by experimenting with multiple resolutions.

The comparison of the radial distribution of the projected stellar and gas densities (Figure 6.11) and of the observable intensity as a function of stellar age (Figure 6.12) match the observations reasonably well, supporting the [Hacar et al. \(2017\)](#) conclusions. This conclusion cannot be made if we start with a smaller ($\lesssim 1.4$ pc) or larger ($\gtrsim 3$ pc) molecular cloud, if we add more than 10% of break-up rotation to the cloud, or if we switch off the stellar-wind mass loss.

6.5.4 Collapsing Molecular Cloud in grid-based hydrodynamics

Simulating the collapse of a giant molecular cloud is really a multi-scale and multi-physics effort; it probably takes several codes cooperating to realize such a simulation. For instance, one requires the hydrodynamics, radiative processes, but also gravity, stellar evolution and many other calculations to jointly lead to a satisfactory and reliable calculation. It is too early to dwell on the details of such a calculation, but in Section 10.2.1 we dwell into some of the more detailed efforts we have been pursuing in a larger collaborative effort in which AMUSE was pivotal.

The one aspect of such a calculation that is of interest here is the possibility of

including specific features, such as asymmetric stellar outflow. One advantage of grid-based hydrodynamics is the natural ease with which specific hydrodynamical phenomena can be included in the calculations. One such example is the asymmetric outflow from low-mass young stars. These stellar jets can be described as the outflow of gas from the stellar surface in a cone with a specific opening angle. Since such processes tend to be implemented directly into the hydro code, it hardly counts as an AMUSE expansion, but rather an internal boundary condition on the hydrodynamics solver.

6.6 Validation

Validating gravity codes is relatively straightforward (see Section 4.6). Conservation of energy and angular momentum is generally the key to reliable results. Hydrodynamics is a very different realm. The most common way to validate the results of a hydrodynamics solver is by means of convergence tests, where one repeats a calculation with the same initial conditions and code settings, but with different resolution, i.e., we vary the grid size or the number of SPH particles, depending on the type of code used. Convergence tests provide quantitative information about the behavior of the code, and (with luck) on the correct solution of the studied system. However, even if the results converge, there is still no guarantee that the converged solution (or, more often, the solution approaching convergence) is correct. This requires additional validation.

Explicit validation is only possible in a few very limited cases where an analytic or semi-analytic solution is known (Landau & Lifshitz, 1959). More often, one has to compare new simulation results with previously computed “standard” solutions (Klingenberg *et al.*, 2007). Such comparisons have been undertaken for SPH (Thacker *et al.*, 2000) and for grid-based hydrodynamics, as in the Santa Barbara Cluster Comparison Project (Frenk *et al.*, 1999). Others focus on specific aspects of physical processes, such as comparing the expansion of a shell of shocked neutral HII in an ionized medium using a variety of codes (Bisbas *et al.*, 2015). Such comparisons reveal that both Eulerian mesh codes and standard SPH methods without artificial conductivity³ (in addition to artificial viscosity) have significant problems even in rather idealized simulations (see also Saitoh & Makino, 2016).

Thus, it is almost impossible to validate the results obtained by hydrodynamics codes, at least at the level of confidence typical in pure gravitational problems, and we advise caution in interpreting the results. In this section, we focus on validating codes via comparison with an exact solution (Section 6.6.1), and by comparing the results of a number of different codes. In the latter case, no analytic solution exists, but conventional wisdom states that, if several different codes give similar results, those results are probably qualitatively correct.

³Artificial conductivity is an additional dissipative term introduced into the energy equation in order to handle discontinuities in the fluid’s thermal energy (Monaghan, 1997; Price, 2008).

6.6.1 Riemann Shock Tube Problem

The one-dimensional Riemann shock tube test is one of the few nonlinear hydrodynamical problems for which an analytic solution exists (Landau & Lifshitz, 1959). The test setup consists of two fluids of different densities and pressures separated by a membrane at the center of the grid. The simulation starts when the membrane is suddenly removed. The solution shows three distinct discontinuities in the fluid: (1) a contact discontinuity that marks the current interface between the two fluids, (2) a shock wave that moves from the high-pressure fluid (left) into the low-pressure fluid (right), and (3) an expansion wave that moves in the opposite direction (Tasker *et al.*, 2008).

Figure 6.13 presents the exact Riemann solution at time 0.4 (in dimensionless code units; see Section 2.3.2), as well as the solutions for two hydro codes—one grid-based and one SPH. The exact solution is taken from Toro (1997). The numerical setup follows Tasker *et al.* (2008). All modern grid solvers are designed to pass this test (in fact, they are built around this solution as the means of computing fluxes between adjacent cells), so it is not surprising that the grid code performs extremely well. However, while SPH in one dimension also accurately reproduces the analytic solution, the three-dimensional SPH code used here clearly has far greater difficulty than the grid-based code at comparable resolution. Note also that the way the initial conditions were set up favors the grid code. We started with analytic density and pressure distributions, which naturally map onto a grid-based representation, whereas in the SPH representation, random fluctuations in the particle's positions and velocities lead to Poisson and shot noise.

6.6.2 Kelvin–Helmholtz Test

The Kelvin–Helmholtz instability was discussed in Section 6.1.4.2. Because this instability is fundamental to fluid dynamics, any solver must be tested to determine whether the growth rate of the instability and its developing structure are consistent with earlier calculations (see also Section 6.6). However, it is not precisely known how the development of the instability is affected by the resolution—this is still an active area of research, involving both laboratory experiments and numerical simulations (Kajishima & Taira, 2017). A small script to perform a Kelvin–Helmholtz test is part of the AMUSE test suite, and can be found at `amuse.examples.kelvin_helmholtz`.

Figure 6.14 presents the results of the Kelvin–Helmholtz instability test for three different grid-based hydrodynamics solvers. The red fluid moves to the left and has twice the density and half the speed of the blue fluid, which moves to the right. Even though the three images differ in detail, the characteristic structure of the Kelvin–Helmholtz instability is clearly evident. We did not perform this test for the SPH codes, because they tend to perform very poorly unless we go to extremely high resolution and introduce a special treatment for mixing (Read *et al.*, 2010).

6.6.3 Cloud-shock Test

Another hard test for hydro codes is the cloud-shock test, more popularly known as the blob test (Agertz *et al.*, 2007). This test aims to study interacting multi-phase fluids,

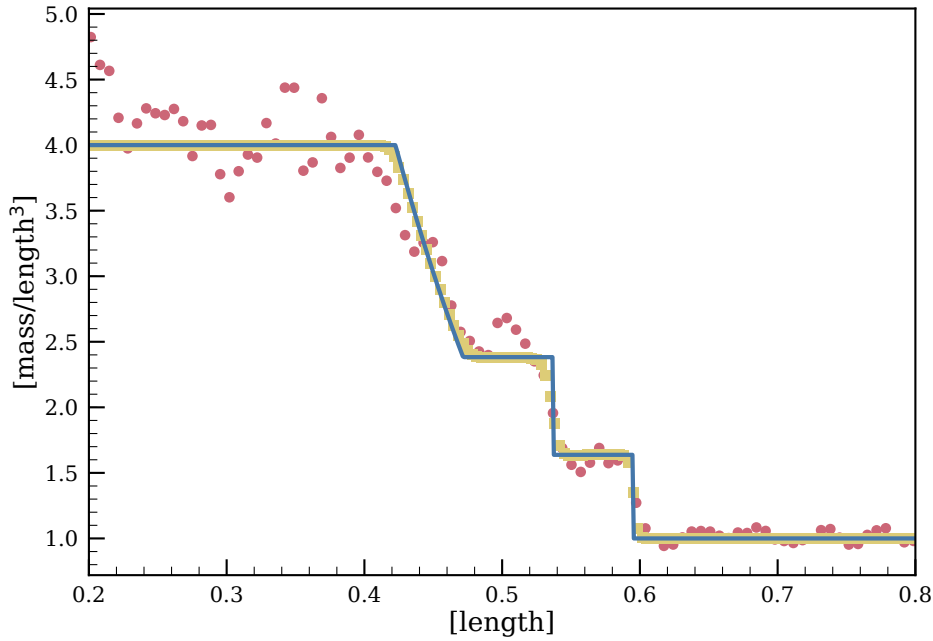


Figure 6.13: Riemann shock tube test using two fluids with a density ratio of 4 to 1, pressure ratio of 1 to 5.571, and with $\gamma = 5/3$. The solid blue line gives the analytic solution to this problem. The yellow squares are the results from the **athena** grid code in one-dimensional mode with 100 cells spanning the computational domain. The red bullets indicate the results using the SPH code **Fi** calculated in three-dimensions using 10^7 particles. To be fair we note that **athena** is working here in 1D, whereas the SPH code **Fi** operates in 3D, using a rather small number of particles for this test. The apparent poor result for the SPH code then is really a demonstration of how low resolution in SPH can still give reasonable results. The source code for this test can be found in `amuse.examples.test_riemann_shock_tube_problem`. The figure was made using the script `amuse.examples.plot_riemann_shock_tube_rho`. Running the analytic code takes a few seconds, **athena** takes about 10 minutes and **Fi** about 18 hours (single core) on a laptop.

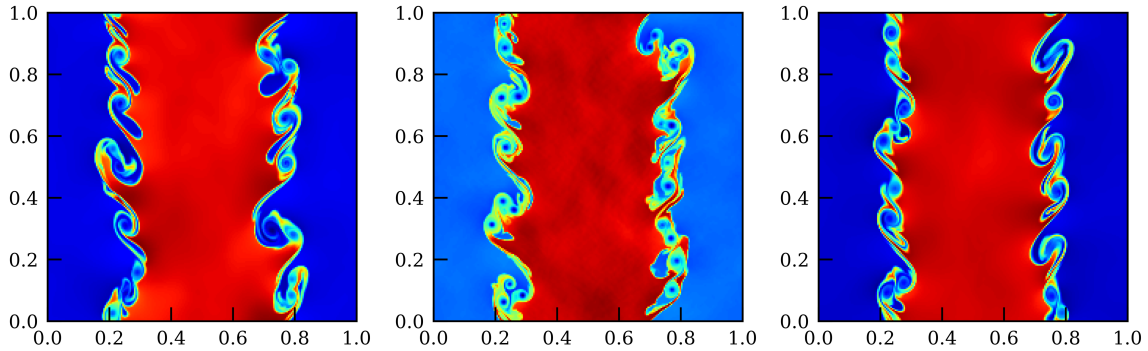


Figure 6.14: Result of the Kelvin-Helmholtz test for three different grid-based hydrodynamics codes, **athena** (left), **capreole** (middle), and **mpiamrvac** (right), on a 2-dimensional 211×211 mesh (see [Pelupessy et al., 2013](#); for details). We seeded the initial system with random velocities of amplitude $0.01c_s$. Here we show the density distribution at $t = 1$. The source code took for this test about a minute to run and can be found in `amuse.examples.kelvin_helmholtz`.

which are generally poorly resolved by SPH techniques, whereas Eulerian grid-based methods are able to resolve the most important dynamical instabilities. In this test, a cloud is compressed by a high Mach number inflow, and forms a contact discontinuity between the high-density and the low-density material. The experiment is meant to mimic the shock-induced star formation process, except that there is no gravity. We present the results of this test using three different grid-based hydrodynamics solvers

in AMUSE in Figure 6.15.

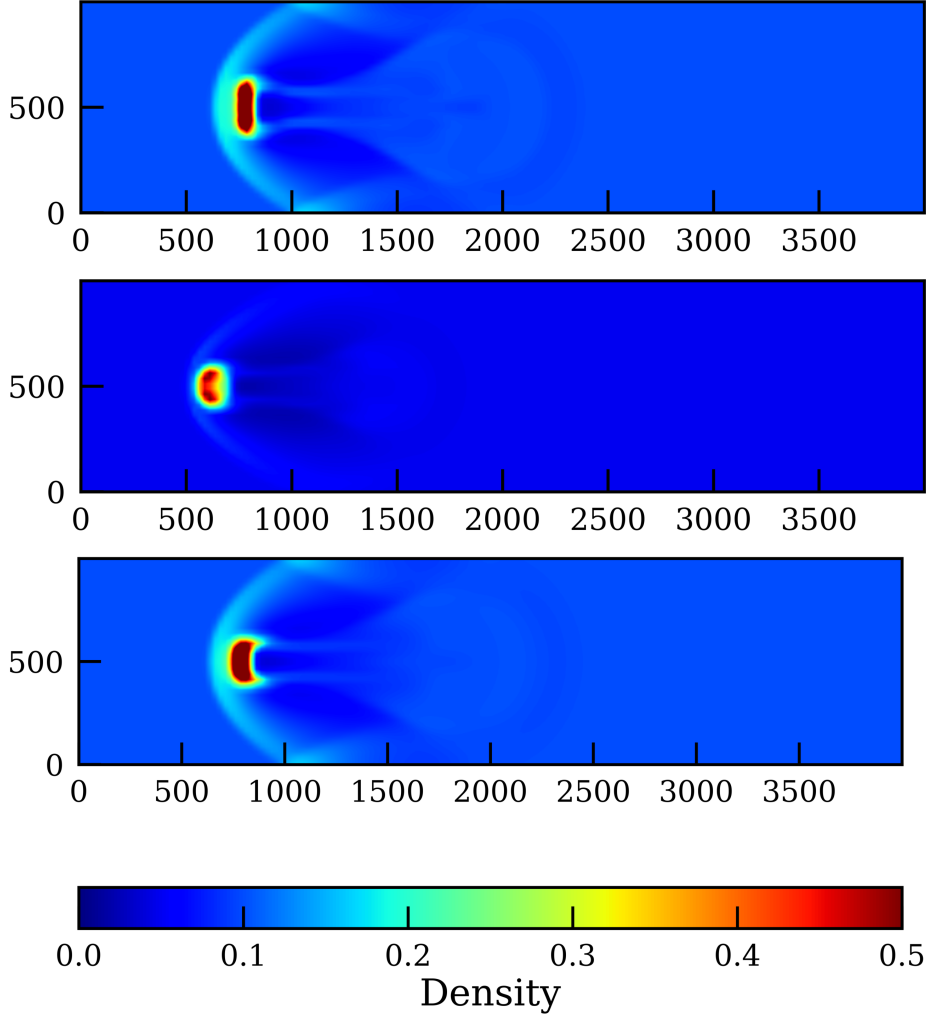


Figure 6.15: Comparison of the results of the cloud-shock test (Agertz *et al.*, 2007) for 3 grid-based hydrodynamics codes **capreole** (top), **mpiamrvac** (middle), and **athena** (bottom). The color bar indicates the relative normalized density. Panels show slices through the density distribution at time $t = \tau_{\text{KH}}$ (see Eq. 6.25). The resolution for **athena** and **capreole** is $320 \times 320 \times 1280$, for **mpiamrvac** it is $80 \times 80 \times 320$ with 2 levels of refinement for comparable effective resolution. The source code for this test is a standard application in AMUSE and can be found in `amuse.examples.cloudshock`. This image was first presented in Pelupessy *et al.* (2013). The various codes have a quite similar runtime of about 2 minutes.

Smoothed particle hydrodynamics codes use the local density distribution to derive the spatial derivatives of other quantities, which therefore should always remain differentiable. It is exactly this assumption that breaks down in the blob test, causing SPH codes to perform poorly. By working instead with the internal energy density (or pressure), which changes smoothly across the discontinuity boundary, as the volume element used for the kernel integration, the contact discontinuity can be resolved without numerical problems (Saitoh & Makino, 2013).

6.6.4 Boss–Bodenheimer Test

Finally, we perform the Boss–Bodenheimer test for fragmentation in a rotating proto-star (Boss & Bodenheimer, 1979). This test is often used to validate cloud collapse and the star formation process in hydrodynamical simulations. In this case, we use an SPH code, which provides a satisfactory solution. The experimental setup is a uniform spherical isothermal gas cloud of mass $1 M_{\odot}$ and radius 0.01 pc , to which a bar-like density perturbation of amplitude 50% is added. The bar initially rotates as a rigid body with constant angular speed $1.56 \times 10^{-12} \text{ rad s}^{-1}$. The calculation was performed using **Fi** with 50,000 SPH particles. The cloud collapses on a time scale of roughly the initial freefall time ($t_{\text{ff}} \approx 0.175 \text{ Myr}$), and forms two blobs containing approximately 80% of the total mass. The remaining gas is ejected.

In the AMUSE test, illustrated in Figure 6.16, we can qualitatively see how the perturbation develops. A more useful validation is realized by making a comparison with other simulation codes. This test could, for example, be run relatively easily using a grid-based hydrodynamics solver, and the reader may take up this challenge in Section 6.7.2.

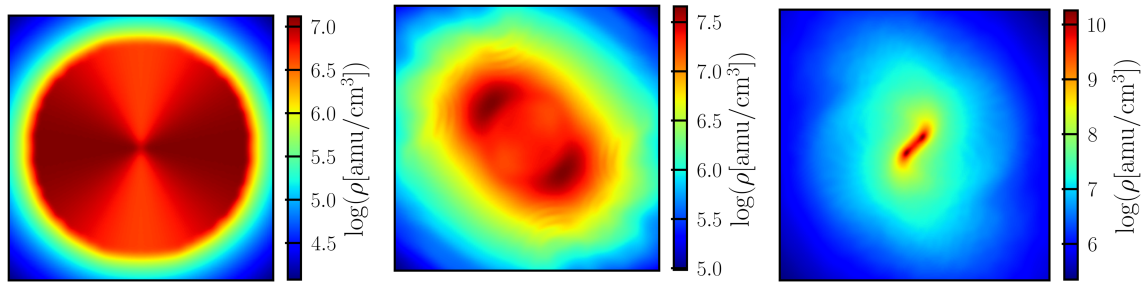


Figure 6.16: Three snapshots of the Boss–Bodenheimer test for a $1 M_{\odot}$ uniform isothermal spherical cloud with radius 0.01 pc . Initially (left), a non-axisymmetric 50% $m = 2$ perturbation is visible. It rotates as a rigid body with constant angular speed of $1.56 \times 10^{-12} \text{ rad/s}$. The middle image shows the projected gas distribution at an age of $0.836 t_{\text{ff}}$. The right panel shows the state of the system at $1.5 t_{\text{ff}}$. The calculation was performed using **Fi** with 50,000 SPH particles. The source code for this test is a standard simple AMUSE example and can be found in `amuse.examples.boss_bodenheimer_test`. It runs in about five minutes on a laptop.

There is no analytic solution to this problem, except that one can check conservation of mass, energy, and angular momentum throughout the test. We stopped the calculation after $1.5 t_{\text{ff}}$ because the local densities in the two blobs became rather high, dramatically slowing the SPH code. We could continue the calculation beyond this stage by introducing sink particles and allowing them to absorb some of the highest-density gas (see Section 6.3.4).

6.7 Assignments

6.7.1 Convergence Test

Ideally, aside from unphysical behavior of a code due to incorrect or absent physics, its behavior should be independent of the number of particles in the SPH code, the opening

angle in a tree code, the softening length, or the number of cells in the grid code. In reality, the results generally depend on these resolution and accuracy parameters. In practice, you will probably want to perform production calculations with the minimum number of grid cells or SPH particles that produce acceptable results, in order to have as efficient a simulation as possible. (Here, efficiency can be expressed in terms of computer time, wall-clock time, disk storage, memory usage, etc., and is generally problem-dependent.)

For hydrodynamics codes, the number of SPH particles or the number of grid cells are the most common handles for measuring convergence. It is generally best to start a convergence test with as few SPH particles or as coarse a grid as one dares. In subsequent simulations, the resolution can be increased, typically by factors of two, until the outcome becomes independent of the resolution. The outcome might be a graph with some measure of the resolution (number of grid cells in each dimension, or the number of SPH particles) along the x -axis, and the desired result on the y -axis.

In practice, simulations do not always reach convergence, because the required resolution may be beyond the available resources, such as computer time or total memory. In those cases, it is still possible to validate the result so long as the behavior of the system asymptotically approaches a certain value, and the performance curve can be extrapolated to the desired resolution.

In Section 8.5.4, we discussed how a collision between two stars can be resolved using an SPH code. Here, we use this example to carry out a convergence test for the SPH simulations. We perform the test by increasing the number of SPH particles from $10/M_\odot$ to $10^4/M_\odot$, then increasing the number of particles by a factor of 10 for each subsequent simulation. The results are presented in Figure 6.17. We will run the simulation as described in Section 8.5.4.2 and plot the temperature and density profiles of the merger product with varying resolution.

- Perform your own resolution test, starting with two stars of masses $6 M_\odot$ and $5 M_\odot$, each evolved to an age of 100 Myr.
- For the test case in Figure 6.17, the results seem to converge rather quickly. Is this a general result? Do your simulations also converge for $N \gtrsim 1000$ SPH particles per $M_\odot$?
- Plot the wall-clock computer time as a function of resolution, and discuss how the cost in computer time grows with increasing resolution.
- Instead of using an SPH code, the same problem can also be done with a grid code (see Section 6.2.5). In that case, use the number of grid cells as a measure of resolution. Perform a similar analysis as for the SPH convergence test and address the same questions.

6.7.2 Testing the Boss–Bodenheimer Test

In Section 6.6.4, we performed the Boss–Bodenheimer test using the SPH code **Fi**. We continued the calculation up to $1.5 t_{\text{ff}}$, after which two blobs of relatively high density

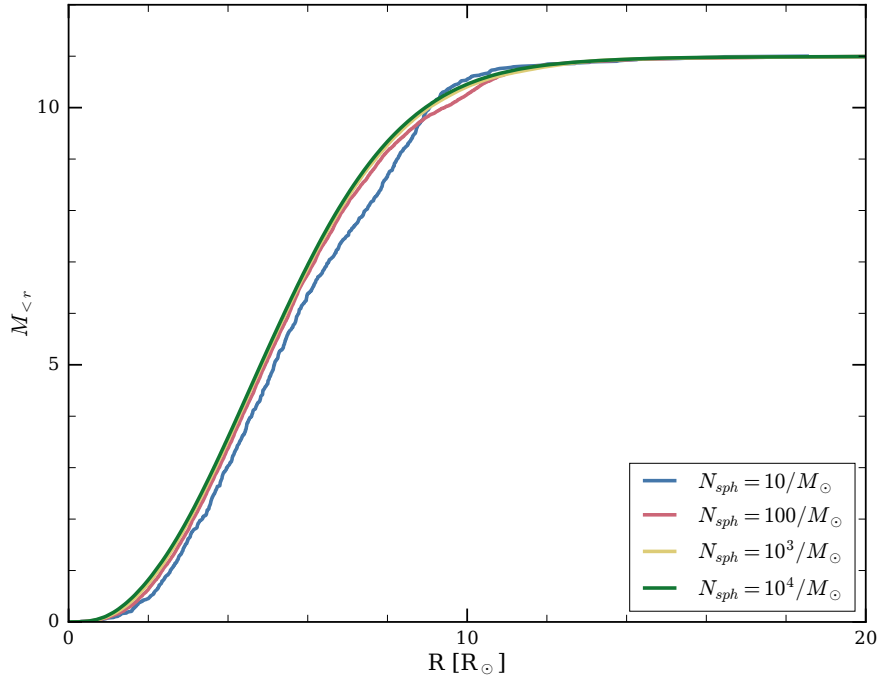


Figure 6.17: Convergence test for a hydrodynamical simulation of a merger of two stars of masses $10 M_{\odot}$ and $1 M_{\odot}$, with initial parameters otherwise identical to those discussed in Section 8.5.4. Here we adapt the calculation to perform a convergence test using 10, 100, 10^3 and 10^4 equal-mass SPH particles per solar mass to resolve the stars. The source code for this convergence test is `amuse.examples.merge_two_stars_sph_convergence`.

started to appear. This is the classic result of the Boss–Bodenheimer test. We stopped the calculation because the high density forced the SPH code to run very slowly.

We can imagine at least two solutions that enable us to continue the calculation. One is to introduce sink particles in the highest-density regions of the gas distribution and integrate them as `dm_particles`. Another is to repeat the test using one of the available grid-based codes in AMUSE. Specifically, the adaptive mesh refinement code **Athena** should do a reasonable job of following the formation of the binary system in this test calculation; `mpiamrvac` is less suitable because the test requires self-gravity. Running the SPH code with sink particles is straightforward, but converting the three-dimensional particle distribution including the velocities to a grid is somewhat more elaborate.

Do the grid and SPH codes give similar masses and orbital parameters for the two stars that form?

6.7.3 The Dissolving Bump

In Section 6.4.1 we discussed the dissolution of a massive perturbation in a protoplanetary disk around a $10 M_{\odot}$ star. In this assignment, we will study the time scale on which such a bump dissolves. From the calculation in Section 6.4.1, we already know that the bump has dissolved after about 20 orbits, but we did not discuss the actual time scale for dissolution. The time scale can be derived from the calculations if we are able to recognize the bump at run time and measure its mass.

The bump in the hydro particle set can be identified by using `hop` (see Section 8.5.4.3). In this assignment you will repeat the calculation in Section 6.4.1, but identify and measure the bump's mass at run time. Make a plot of the mass of the bump as a function of time, and discuss the mass evolution. What happens to the bump-dissolution time scale if the mass of the central star and the mass of the disk and bump are all reduced by a factor of 10?

6.7.4 Collapsing Molecular Cloud with Sink Particles

In Section 6.5 we demonstrated the collapse of a giant molecular cloud. Even at this rather low resolution, the high densities reached in the simulation brought the code to a grinding halt. The solution was to introduce sink particles to reduce the computational load on the hydro solver. The size of a sink particle, and hence the limiting density that can be resolved, depends on the resolution of the simulation. This limiting density can be calculated by assuming that the volume containing $n_{\text{crit}} = 64$ particles (a typical number of SPH neighbors) is barely Jeans unstable (see Section 6.1.4.3):

$$\rho_{\text{threshold}} = \frac{\pi^5 e^3}{36 G^3 m^2 n_{\text{crit}}^2}. \quad (6.33)$$

Here, $e \simeq c_s^2$ is the specific internal energy of the gas, which in our case (a cold molecular cloud of temperature $T = 15$ K, similar to what we used in Section 6.5) is $e \simeq 0.08 \text{ km}^2 \text{ s}^{-2}$, and $m \simeq 2 \times 10^{29} \text{ kg}$ is the mass of a single SPH particle in a somewhat more refined simulation capable of resolving solar-mass objects. We convert between e and T using

$$T = \frac{2e\mu}{3k}, \quad (6.34)$$

where

$$\mu = 2m_p \left(X + \frac{1}{2}Y\right)^{-1} \simeq 2.4m_p \quad (6.35)$$

for molecular hydrogen gas and solar composition. In this case, we find $\rho_{\text{threshold}} \simeq 8.5 \times 10^{-20} \text{ g cm}^{-3}$ and a sink radius of $\lambda_J = 0.13 \text{ pc}$ (see Equation 6.27).

Run the hydro code and generate sink particles as soon as the local density (i.e., the density of a single SPH particle) exceeds the threshold density $\rho_{\text{threshold}}$. Turn that particular particle into a sink particle by removing it from the gas and adding it to the hydro code as a `dm_particle`. We will have to do the mergers of the sink particles by hand, as we discussed in Section 4.5.1. Monitor the number of sink particles, and how their total mass increases with time. To validate the method, also plot the maximum gas density found in any of the SPH particles as a function of time. This maximum density should be limited by the adopted threshold density.

Measure, in several calculations, the moment when the first sink particle forms. Use the hydro code stopping condition to check for sink particle formation, then terminate the integration and print the time at which this occurs. This time is not always the same, but varies from run to run. Does this time also vary systematically for different resolutions? Why is it not the free-fall time scale?

6.7.5 A Star-forming Region

In Section 6.5.3 we discussed the correlation of the intensity of N_2H^+ emission with the positions of protostars and young stellar objects. Our calculation was realized with dual resolution using two different masses for the particles in the SPH code, in order to allow a relatively low-resolution model of the star formation process. This is usually a bad idea (but see Section 6.5.3), and can cause a whole raft of other problems, but in that example we wanted to have some quick results in order to obtain a first impression of the physical processes and their consequences. Here, we encourage the reader to further discuss this resolution issue.

Perform the same simulation as in Section 6.5.3, with a total of 200,000 SPH particles (corresponding to a mass resolution of $0.005 M_\odot$), and reproduce the two figures Figures 6.11 and 6.12. Was the observed numerical correlation a consequence of the dual resolution in the SPH simulation?

6.7.6 Neutron Star Hits Companion

Construct a hydrodynamical realization of a main sequence star of mass $10 M_\odot$. Fire a neutron star at that star, from a distance equal to twice the stellar radius ($R_\star$) at a velocity of 1000 km s^{-1} . This is pretty fast, but during a supernova, the newly formed neutron star can acquire such a high speed due to asymmetries in the explosion. This problem can be run with a grid or an SPH code, although the latter makes it easier to include the neutron star as a point mass in the form of a `dm_particle`.

1. Perform a convergence test on the number of SPH particles for this problem where the neutron star is launched head-on into the star (see Section 6.7.1).

Run a first test with a few (say, 100) SPH particles in the target star, and measure the behavior of the system. Does the neutron star stick to the companion star? How much mass is lost by the target star, and how much kinetic energy does the ejected mass carry? Run subsequent simulations with higher resolution, 500 SPH particles, 2000 articles, 4000, etc., until the results converge or your patience runs out.

Make a figure of the resulting diagnostics of the convergence test as a function of resolution.

2. Repeat the convergence test for an impact parameter of $d = 0.5R_\star$. Was the resolution adopted after the initial convergence test (for $d = 0$) sufficient?
3. Finally, repeat the experiment with the same target star on the giant branch. Sadly, the convergence test will have to be redone, because the different structure of the target star is likely to change the behavior of the adopted code.

For this second experiment, the same code used to generate Figure 6.6 (`amuse.examples.star_to_sph`) can also be use used to make an SPH realization of a giant star. You may want to use a `dm_particle` to represent the stellar core,

in order to avoid spending all the available computer time on the hydrodynamics of the giant's central region.

6.7.7 Supernova Explosion

In Section 6.2.5 we discussed the use of a simple two-component stellar model with constant density in each of the components to serve as a starting model for a hydrodynamical simulation of an exploding star. It is relatively straightforward to instead adopt the result of an actual Henyey code and convert the one-dimensional density structure of a star into a three-dimensional grid. In Section 6.2.5, we explored a similar approach but converted the stellar grid structure to a particle representation in order to resolve the hydrodynamics using an SPH code.

In this assignment, we will simulate a type Ic supernova using a grid code. We start with a $12 M_{\odot}$ star, which we evolve to a radius of $100 R_{\odot}$, which happens at an age of ~ 14.6 Myr. We assume that, at this stage, the star overfills its Roche lobe in the binary system to which it belongs, and loses its envelope. The stripping of the hydrogen-rich layers has to be done in the stellar structure model, using a Henyey code; see Section 5.2.8. Code example 6.7 demonstrates how this can be done.

```

43 number_of_zones = se_star.get_number_of_zones()
44 composition = se_star.get_chemical_abundance_profiles()
45 # first zone with X > 1.0e-9
46 index = (composition[0] > 1.0e-9).nonzero()[0][0]
47
48 print(
49     f"Creating helium star, from the inner {index} (out of {number_of_zones})"
50     f"shells."
51 )
52 helium_star_in_code = stellar_evolution.new_particle_from_model(
53     {
54         "mass": (se_star.get_cumulative_mass_profile() * se_star.mass)[:index],
55         "radius": se_star.get_radius_profile()[:index],
56         "rho": se_star.get_density_profile()[:index],
57         "temperature": se_star.get_temperature_profile()[:index],
58         "luminosity": se_star.get_luminosity_profile()[:index],
59         "X_H": composition[0][:index],
60         "X_He": composition[1][:index] + composition[2][:index],
61         "X_C": composition[3][:index],
62         "X_N": composition[4][:index],
63         "X_O": composition[5][:index],
64         "X_Ne": composition[6][:index],
65         "X_Mg": composition[7][:index],
66         "X_Si": composition[7][:index] * 0.0,
67         "X_Fe": composition[7][:index] * 0.0,
68     },
69     0.0 | units.Myr,
70 )
71

```

Code example 6.7: Snippet demonstrating how to strip the outer helium-rich layers of an evolved star. This is a fragment from the script `amuse.examples.helium_star`.

Figure 6.18 shows the evolution of a $12 M_{\odot}$ star in a Hertzsprung–Russell diagram, up to the time when it reaches a size of $100 R_{\odot}$. The star is subsequently stripped of its hydrogen layers, using the procedure in Code example 6.7. This leaves us with a helium star of $\sim 1.85 M_{\odot}$, which we continue to evolve using the Henyey code for another 0.21 Myr.

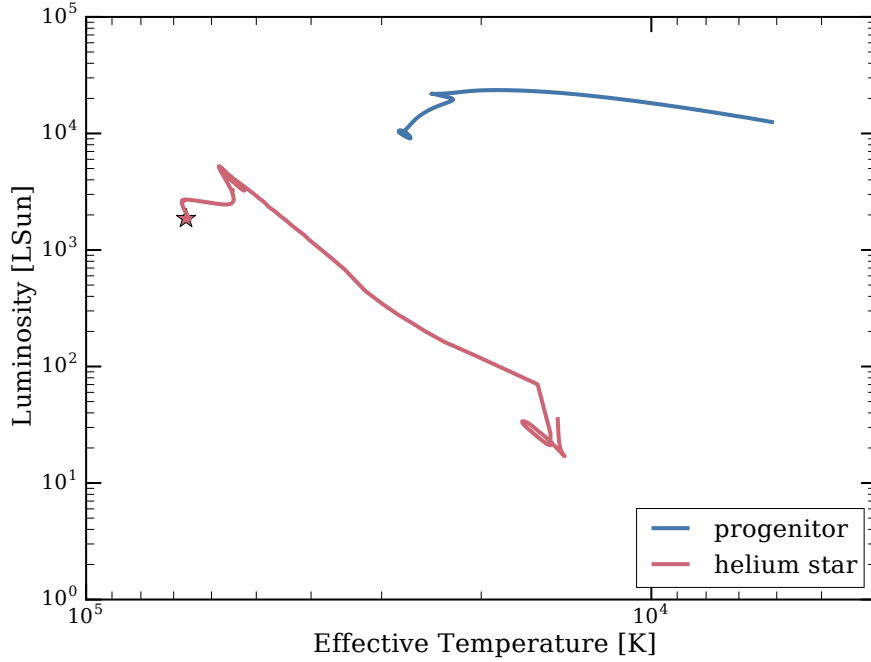


Figure 6.18: Blue curve: Evolutionary track of a $12 M_{\odot}$ star for 14.6 Myr. The outer layers of the star are then stripped, as described in the text, and the helium core is evolved for a further 0.21 Myr (red track), eventually exploding as a supernova, marked by the star. The source code for this test is a standard simple AMUSE example and can be found in `amuse.examples.helium_star`.

Ideally, we would like to continue evolving the star until just before the supernova occurs, but the AMUSE Henyey codes will likely encounter problems and crash at an earlier stage. Using a `stopping_condition` or exception handling to catch the right moment to ignite the supernova does not really work in these cases. Instead, we simply ignite the supernova at the moment at which the Henyey code fails to converge. In the example from `amuse.examples.helium_star`, we evolved the helium star for 10^3 internal time steps, because this brings the star sufficiently close to exploding.

Once the stellar evolution is finished, convert the one-dimensional Henyey representation of the star into a three-dimensional grid. Use this grid as the initial conditions for exploding the star, using the “thermal bomb” approach adopted earlier. Inject a total energy of $\sim 10^{51}$ erg into the inner $1.4 M_{\odot}$ of the star, and divide that explosive energy across this volume, assuming constant energy per unit mass.

As a second objective, use an SPH code to simulate the supernova explosion. In that case, you will have to convert the initial three-dimensional stellar realization into a representative particle set. There are two complementary ways to do this:

- Adopt the method described in Section 6.4.2, where the Henyey model is converted directly to a particle set, or from the grid generated from the Henyey code

at the beginning of this exercise.

- Use the separate routine `convert_grid_to_SPH` to convert the grid you generated from the Henyey code directly to a particle set.

For the grid code and the SPH simulations, plot the temperature and the density in the supernova shell, as functions of time.

- Compare the temperature profile of the stellar evolution model with the result after the stellar model is converted to the grid.
- Run both initial realizations with the same grid-based hydro code, and compare the results.

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